



CITY: Pg 3

World Environment Day, 18 green gifts



NATION: Pg 5

Cong seeks to cash in by creating chaos: PM



FILM: Pg 14

Hrithik says he isn't getting the roles he wants

India beats the odds, delivers 7.7% FY26 growth, 7.8% in Q4

FY27 growth forecast cut to 6.6% due to higher energy prices, commodity costs supply-chain disruptions

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: Amid an uncertain global situation owing to ongoing regional wars, India's economy expanded 7.8 per cent in the January-March quarter, exceeding forecasts on strong domestic demand and government expenditure.

The GDP growth compared with 7 per cent expansion a year back and 8 per cent in the previous quarter. Full-year growth accelerated to 7.7 per cent from 7.1 per cent in FY25, supported by healthy consumption and robust investment activity.

In a post on X, Prime Minister Narendra Modi stated, "India's growth momentum remains strong! GDP growth rate of 7.7% in FY 2025-26 and 7.8% in Q4 of FY 2025-26 reflect the inherent strength of our economy, the success of reforms and the hard work of 140 crore Indians."



The January-March period accounted for just one month of disruptions caused by the war in Iran. The spike in oil prices and the disruption in supplies from the Middle East — a key source for India's

crude oil, natural gas and LPG — will be fully visible in the current April-June quarter.

The Reserve Bank of India has already cut its 2026-27 (FY27) GDP growth forecast to 6.6 per cent from 6.9 per

cent, citing elevated energy and commodity prices and persistent supply-chain disruptions linked to the conflict in West Asia.

Chief Economic Adviser V Anantha Nageswaran,

addressing a press conference after the release of the data, said India could return to a growth rate of more than 7 per cent in FY28 if external conditions improve.

He said even if growth

slows below 7 per cent in FY27, as projected by the RBI, policy measures aimed at preserving macroeconomic stability and ensuring adequate supplies could help the economy return to a growth trajectory above 7 per cent in FY28, provided external conditions improve.

However, on the contrary, Nageswaran further stressed the increased adverse global developments. The escalating conflict in West Asia has emerged as the single biggest risk to the country's growth trajectory, threatening to fuel inflation, widen trade deficits and disrupt energy supplies, data shows.

Gross value added, which strips out the volatile components such as indirect taxes and government subsidies to present a more accurate measure of underlying economic activity, grew 7.9 per cent during the

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TAKEAWAYS

» Q4 captured only one month of Iran conflict impact; full effect on oil prices and supply disruptions expected in April-June quarter

» Escalating West Asia conflict may raise inflation, widen trade deficit and disrupt energy supplies

» Real GDP FY26: Rs 323.12 lakh crore vs Rs 299.89 lakh crore in FY25

» Nominal GDP FY26: Rs 346.36 lakh crore vs Rs 318.07 lakh crore; growth of 8.9%

» New GDP Series: Second release based on FY23 as the base year

KARU NAGARAJAN ALSO QUILTS

Annamalai, who took BJP's visibility to new high in Tamil Nadu, quits party

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI/CHENNAI: Former Tamil Nadu BJP president K Annamalai on Friday resigned from the Bharatiya Janata Party and announced the launch of a new political movement, marking a major development in the state's political landscape ahead of the 2026 Assembly elections. The 42-year-old former IPS officer said his decision followed nearly 18 months of discussions with the BJP leadership and was driven by his vision of building an inclusive political platform centred on ordinary



K Annamalai

PTI

citizens rather than personality-based politics. Alongside the announcement, several BJP functionaries declared their support for Annamalai's new venture, signalling the possibility of an

early organisational shift in Tamil Nadu politics.

In a social media address, Annamalai said he had left the BJP respectfully and after informing the party leadership

“FROM TODAY ONWARDS, A NEW PATH, A NEW MOVEMENT; A NEW POLITICAL MOVEMENT”

well in advance. He stated that he had conveyed his intention to resign on December 4, 2024, and was subsequently asked by senior leaders to complete election-related responsibilities before stepping away from the party.

"The National President of the Bharatiya Janata Party, Nitin Nabin, has accepted the resignation submitted by the Tamil Nadu Ex-State President, K Annamalai, from the primary membership of the party," BJP national general secretary Arun Singh said in a statement.

Annamalai, who met Union Home Minister

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MONSOON MOMENT



A man covers himself and a child during rainfall, in Nainital, Uttarakhand, Friday

PTI

REJECTS BANGLADESH'S ALLEGATIONS

Deportations follow law, not 'pushbacks': India

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: India snubbed the Bangladeshi government's allegations of forcibly pushing undocumented migrants across the border, asserting that all deportations are carried out strictly in accordance with "established legal procedures" and "bilateral mechanisms".

While quizzed during the press briefing here, in the national capital on Friday, Ministry of External Affairs spokesman Randhir Jaiswal clarified and said that India has a well-defined framework to deal with foreign nationals residing illegally in the country, including



A Bangladeshi national with his belongings leaves India through Hakimpur checkpoint after launch of SIR, in Bengal

ANI/FILE

those from Bangladesh.

The official further noted that "...the process of deporta-

tion involves identifying people who were living illegally within the territory of India without any

proper documentation. Once their nationality is confirmed by the officials

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KEY POINTS

- » India has a defined framework for dealing with illegal foreign nationals
- » The process begins with identifying undocumented migrants residing illegally
- » Deportation proceeds only after nationality is officially verified
- » Verification must come from authorities of the concerned country
- » India says repatriation follows specific laws and organised procedures

NO RESTRICTIONS

Putin offers India full partnership on Sukhoi fighter jets

MPOST BUREAU

ST PETERSBURG: Russian President Vladimir Putin has offered India the opportunity to jointly develop and manufacture the fifth-generation Sukhoi Su-57 stealth fighter aircraft, signalling Moscow's continued interest in deepening defence cooperation with New Delhi even as India expands its indigenous military capabilities and diversifies its procurement sources. During an interaction with heads of leading global news agencies, including PTI, Putin also voiced strong support for India's independent foreign policy, praised Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership, projected a significant expansion in bilateral trade, and expressed confidence that India and China would resolve their border differences through dialogue.

Addressing questions from PTI CEO and Editor-in-Chief Vijay Joshi, the only Indian journalist present at the interaction on Thursday night, Putin said Russia remained willing to involve India in the Su-57 programme despite previous setbacks in efforts to jointly develop a fifth-generation combat aircraft.

"As for the Su-57, we offered our friends from India to jointly develop this machine, a fifth-generation aircraft. I think it's the best to date. But our Indian friends said, 'well, let's see,'" Putin said.

He added that Russia was prepared to go much further in the partnership. "In principle, this could have been our product. We made it independently. And we are ready to work with India. To work and develop. There will be no restrictions whatsoever."

The offer comes at a time when India is pursuing its ambitious Advanced Multi-role Combat Aircraft (AMCA) programme, considered the country's largest indigenous



Russian President Vladimir Putin

PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Putin is expected to visit India in September for the BRICS Summit
- » India had exited the earlier FGFA project in 2021 due to an estimated USD 30 billion (Rs 2 lakh crore) cost
- » HAL is reportedly still in touch with Sukhoi Design Bureau regarding possible cooperation
- » Russia also offered cooperation on air defence systems
- » India signed a USD 5 billion deal for five S-400 systems in 2018

Moscow in 2021 that it was unwilling to proceed with the project, largely because of the estimated cost of around USD 30 billion, or nearly Rs 2 lakh crore.

Despite the earlier decision, discussions between the two sides have not completely ended. It is understood that state-run Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) remains in contact with the Sukhoi Design Bureau regarding possible areas of cooperation.

The timeline of the AMCA programme is also influencing India's considerations. Since the indigenous aircraft is unlikely to

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India, US aim to seal first phase of trade pact by mid-July, says Goyal

Both nations revisit trade framework amid changing tariff

MPOST BUREAU

VISAKHAPATNAM: India and the United States are moving closer to finalising the first phase of their proposed bilateral trade agreement, with Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal saying the two countries are working to resolve the remaining issues and could sign the initial pact by the middle of next month.

Speaking to reporters on Friday, Goyal said a US negotiating team was in New Delhi from June 2 to June 4 for discussions aimed at completing the interim agreement. He said he had also met the delegation

and described progress in the talks as rapid.

"We are fast moving towards closing all the open ends, and I think sometime by the middle of next month or so, we should be in a position to execute a very, very vibrant first tranche," Goyal said.

He added that the agreement would be only the first part of a broader bilateral trade pact and would provide India with preferential market access compared with competing nations. A high-level US delegation, likely led by US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer, is expected to visit India later this month.

According to the Commerce Ministry, negotiators held constructive discussions on trade in goods, non-tariff barriers, customs and trade facilitation, economic security alignment and other areas of mutual interest. The US side was led by chief negotiator Brendan Lynch, while India's team was headed by Darpan Jain, Additional Secretary in the Department of Commerce.

The two countries had agreed on the framework for the first phase of the bilateral trade agreement in a joint statement issued on February 7. Under that framework, the US had agreed to

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ONLY FOR FLEX-FUEL VEHICLES

India launches E85 fuel priced Rs 20 below petrol

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India on Friday rolled out E85 fuel, a high-ethanol petrol blend meant for flex-fuel vehicles, with a price nearly Rs 20 per litre lower than conventional petrol as part of its push to expand cleaner and domestically sourced transport fuels.

Union Petroleum and Natural Gas Minister Hardeep Singh Puri launched the fuel at an Indian Oil outlet in New Delhi on World Environment Day. The fuel is being introduced at 48 public sector fuel stations across the country and

will initially be available only at select outlets.

Puri said the government plans to expand E85 availability to 500 fuel stations by December 2026 and around 5,000 outlets by December 2027.

E85 contains 80-85 per cent ethanol and 14-19 per cent petrol and can only be used in flex-fuel vehicles designed to operate on ethanol blends ranging from E20 to E100.

The minister said India has raised ethanol blending in petrol from 1.53 per cent in 2014 to 20 per cent now, meeting its target five years ahead of schedule. According

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SC orders status quo on deportation of 5 women declared foreigners

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Friday ordered status quo on the deportation of five women while agreeing to hear their petitions challenging the orders declaring them foreigners who allegedly entered into Assam.

A bench of justices Vikram Nath and V Mohana was hearing five separate pleas challenging orders of the Gauhati High Court.

In its order passed on two pleas, the bench said the petitioners, if they were in detention, be not deported till the next date of hearing on July 16.

The high court had rejected the pleas filed by the petitioners seekin quashing of the orders passed by the Foreigners Tribunal declaring them foreigners who had illegally entered into India from Bangladesh.

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AC SHORT CIRCUIT SUSPECTED

Hundreds evacuated after 12th floor flat catches fire in Noida

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: Hundreds of residents of a high-rise residential society were evacuated on Friday morning after a fire broke out in an apartment on the 12th floor, filling the building with thick smoke and triggering panic among occupants.

The blaze was reported around 7 am in Flat No. 1204 of B-2 Tower, occupied by Ankit Agrawal, his wife and their two children. Although the family was inside the apartment when the fire started, all four escaped unharmed.

According to fire department officials, the contents of the flat were completely destroyed. Furniture, electronic appliances and other household belongings were gutted, though no injuries or fatalities were reported.

As smoke spread through the upper floors and common corridors, residents rushed out of their apartments and gathered outside the tower.



Many used staircases and lift lobby areas to reach safety amid fears that the flames could spread to adjoining flats.

Seven fire tenders were rushed to the society after authorities received information about the incident. By the time firefighters arrived, the society's maintenance staff

had activated the building's fire safety system and begun efforts to contain the blaze.

Chief Fire Officer Pradeep Kumar Chaubey said the complex's internal firefighting infrastructure played a crucial role in preventing a major disaster. Firefighters and maintenance personnel used the hydrant network installed within the

CLOSER LOOK

- » Many used staircases and lift lobby areas to reach safety amid fears that the flames could spread to adjoining flats
- » Seven fire tenders were rushed to the society after authorities received information about the incident. By the time firefighters arrived, the society's maintenance staff had activated building's fire safety system

stop the blaze from spreading vertically. A hydraulic platform was also kept on standby to evacuate residents from higher floors if required, but no one was trapped.

The fire was brought under control after nearly an hour of firefighting operations.

Preliminary findings suggest that a short circuit in an air conditioner may have triggered the blaze, although the exact cause will be established after a detailed investigation.

Meanwhile, a video circulating on social media sparked debate over firefighting preparedness, appearing to show water being sprayed only up to the fifth floor while the fire was on the 12th floor.

Fire officials clarified that the operation was aimed at preventing falling embers from igniting lower balconies and said their equipment is capable of tackling fires at heights of up to 100 metres.

Fire at office building in GK-1; 2 firefighters hurt

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A fire broke out in a battery room on the third floor of an office building in Greater Kailash-I, South Delhi, early Friday morning, according to officials.

The Delhi Fire Services (DFS) received a call about the blaze at approximately 2.47 am from the Tata Communications office located opposite Savitri Cinema, the Delhi Fire Service said in an official statement.

In response, 11 fire tenders were deployed to extinguish the flames. According to the DFS, the fire was confined to the battery room on the third floor of the multi-storey building, affecting an area of about



Blaze was brought under control around 7 am, cooling ops continued afterwards

200 square feet.

Two firefighters sustained burn injuries to their hands while battling the fire and were taken to Safdarjung Hospital for treatment, officials said.

The fire was brought under control around 7 am, and cooling operations continued

afterwards to prevent any rekindling. The building consists of a ground floor and five upper floors. No civilian injuries or casualties were reported during the incident.

The cause of the fire is yet to be ascertained. Further details are awaited, officials said.

DU extends PG admission registration deadline

NEW DELHI: Delhi University has extended the registration deadline for postgraduate admissions under the Common Seat Allocation System (CSAS-PG) for the 2026-27 academic session to 4:59 pm on June 9, from the earlier June 7 deadline.

A correction window will remain open from June 10 to June 11 for registered candidates.

According to the university, the first round of seat allocations will be announced on June 15, with fee payment due by June 19.

The second round will be declared on June 22, and candidates must complete fee payment by June 27. Admissions are being conducted on the basis of CUET-PG scores.

News at a glance

WOMAN FOUND DEAD; HUSBAND NABBED: COPS

NEW DELHI: A 21-year-old married woman was found dead under suspicious circumstances at her home in East Delhi's Ghazipur on June 4. The deceased, identified as Khushi, was found on the fourth floor of the house. Police arrested her husband Tarun (26) and brother-in-law Sumit (23) after preliminary investigations pointed to marital discord linked to an alleged extramarital affair. The body has been sent for post-mortem examination and further investigation is underway.

YOUTH HELD FOR STABBING MAN

NEW DELHI: An 18-year-old youth was arrested for allegedly murdering a 25-year-old man following an argument in North Delhi's Model Town area. The accused, Ashu alias Lala, allegedly stabbed Sahil multiple times on May 31 after a dispute escalated near MCD Colony. Police said the victim had allegedly abused and slapped the accused during the confrontation. The murder weapon was recovered, and the accused was arrested after moving a surrender application before a court. Further investigation is on.

BARBER BEATEN TO DEATH: COPS

NEW DELHI: A 36-year-old barber died after allegedly being assaulted in Holambi Khurd village in outer-north Delhi. The victim, Vikas, sustained a head injury and was declared dead at Maharishi Valmiki Hospital. Investigators found blood stains, a broken wooden stick and damaged motorcycle parts along the route between his shop and home, suggesting a violent altercation. Based on a complaint police registered a case.

Court-martialled ex-Army recruit arrested after 33 years in truck driver's murder case

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A man who was selected for the Indian Army in 1984 but was court-martialled and dismissed from service within a year has been arrested after 33 years for allegedly murdering a truck driver and robbing a truck loaded with copper, an officer said on Friday.

Rajender Dagar, now 59, was on the run since 1993 and declared a proclaimed offender the next year. He was arrested on June 1.

"For ... 33 years, he was constantly changing his identities, appearances and locations across several states," Deputy Commissioner of Police (Crime Branch) Sanjeev Kumar Yadav said in a statement.

"Teams tracked down the fugitive despite the absence of digital records, modern surveillance tools and original



case documents from the early 1990s," he said.

The case dates back to June 15, 1993, when Ram Singh, a truck driver from Rajasthan's Jhunjhunu, was allegedly murdered at a hotel in the Lahori Gate area of Old Delhi.

According to police, Rajender and his associates allegedly gave poison to Ram Singh to steal his truck carrying a consignment of copper belonging to a company.

Rajender targeted Ram Singh because he knew his route and the nature of the cargo he was carrying, they said. On June 17, 1993, an FIR

“Officers revisited court records, examined old case files, studied the accused's criminal background. A detailed examination of judicial records revealed Rajender had been involved in similar crimes before”

was registered at Lahori Gate Police Station.

The police found that Ram Singh was last seen in the company of Rajender. But before investigators could close in on him, he disappeared, and was going to remain so for years to come.

Years of no leads into his whereabouts mounted pressure.

"The accused was around 25 when the murder took place and is now nearly 60. No recent photographs, no digital footprint and very limited records from the period. Many of the conventional leads available in

modern investigations simply did not exist when the crime was committed," the DCP said.

Officers revisited court records, examined old case files and studied the accused's criminal background in detail. A detailed examination of judicial records revealed that Rajender had allegedly been involved in similar crimes in the past.

The police found references to cases involving cheating truck drivers, stealing loaded vehicles and misappropriating valuable consignments. Investigators believed these patterns could help them understand his movements and habits.

"The team then focused on the accused's native village in Rajasthan's Jhunjhunu. Officers discreetly gathered information about his family members and conducted repeated field visits over several months," the DCP said.

The investigation led to the information that Rajender was alive and often visited his village, although he remained extremely cautious and avoided prolonged stays.

The breakthrough came when a suspicious mobile phone number surfaced during surveillance.

Police tracked Rajender to a hotel in Haryana's Narnaul, ending a 33-year manhunt. Investigators said he confessed to murdering a truck driver in 1993, having spent decades changing identities, appearances and locations while working various jobs across India.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GURUGRAM: Gurugram police arrested a man for strangling his wife to death with a scarf after he saw her talking on the phone at midnight and she refused to hand over the device, police said on Friday in Bans Aliyar village.

Police said four children were sleeping on the roof of the house at the time of the incident, adding that the accused suspected that his wife was talking with another man.

According to the police, the accused, 37-year-old Narendra Singh, was living in Bans Aliyar village, IMT Manesar, with his wife, 36-year-old Kajal Devi and four children. Both the husband and wife worked as labourers in a private company. Police said Devi used to

return home from the company at 8:00 pm every day and her husband would arrive at midnight. "On Wednesday, he saw his wife talking to someone on the phone. The angry husband asked her whom she was talking to and demanded her phone, but she refused. An argument ensued between the two. In a fit of rage he killed her due to suspicion and then fled from the scene," police said.

Based on the victim sister's complaint, the police registered an FIR at the IMT Manesar police station.

Police said Narendra is a resident of Nangla Dawda, District Mathura in Uttar Pradesh.

"The police have also recovered the scarf used in the murder, and we are questioning the accused," said the Gurugram police spokesperson.

Mumtaz Gang members held

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has arrested two alleged members of the notorious Mumtaz Gang and apprehended a juvenile in connection with a firing incident linked to an ongoing gang rivalry in North-West Delhi.

The accused have been identified as Amar (26) and Sitesh Jha (23), both residents of Azadpur. Police recovered a Beretta pistol, a country-made pistol and seven live cartridges during the operation.

The case relates to a June 1 shooting in Lal Bagh, Azadpur, in which Sahib alias Salmani, allegedly associated with the rival Hashim Baba Gang, was targeted by three assailants. The



victim survived and reported the incident to police.

Investigators said the attack stemmed from a long-standing feud between the Mumtaz and Hashim Baba gangs. Using technical surveillance, CCTV footage, facial recognition systems and human intelligence, police tracked down the accused after conducting

raids in Delhi as well as Haridwar and Dehradun. According to police, the firing was carried out as retaliation for an earlier altercation between rival gang members during a court production at Rohini Courts. Efforts are underway to arrest the remaining accused, including gang members allegedly involved in planning the attack.

Labourer killed, 2 injured as wall collapses during sewage line works in Lodhi Colony

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 55-year-old labourer was killed and two others were injured after a boundary wall and an adjoining storage room collapsed during rainwater drain and sewage line construction work at Lodhi Crematorium in Delhi's Lodhi Colony area early on Friday, police said.

The incident took place at 1.08 am when excavation and pipe-laying work was being carried out by the Public Works Department (PWD) using a JCB and a Hydra machine, Deputy Commissioner of

“The injured were identified as Rajesh (48), who sustained injuries to his face and lips and is reported to be stable, and Umar (20), who underwent diagnostic scans and is stated to be out of danger”

Police (Southeast) Hemant Tiwari said. According to police, the excavation triggered the collapse of a boundary wall and an adjacent storage structure, trapping three labourers under the debris.

A call regarding the incident was received at 1.18 am, following which personnel

from the Delhi Fire Services (DFS), local police and ambulance services rushed to the spot. Two workers were pulled out during the initial rescue efforts, while the third was later extricated from the rubble. All three were rushed to the AIIMS Trauma Centre.

The deceased was identified

as Devendra, who was rescued unconscious and declared brought dead at the hospital, police said.

The injured were identified as Rajesh (48), who sustained injuries to his face and lips and is reported to be stable, and Umar (20), who underwent diagnostic scans and is stated to be out of danger, they said.

The rescue operation has been completed and the site secured, officials said.

Police have initiated an inquiry to ascertain responsibility for the incident and necessary legal action is being taken in accordance with law.

HC rejects 2020 Delhi riots accused Devangana Kalita's plea seeking videos and WhatsApp chats

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Friday dismissed riots accused Devangana Kalita's petition seeking direction to the police to provide her certain videos and WhatsApp chats in two cases related to the communal violence during the 2020 protests against the CAA and NRC.

Justice Neena Bansal Krishna also refused to continue the court's interim order asking the trial court not to pass final order on framing of charges in the case which pertains to the alleged larger conspiracy behind the unrest.

Kalita's counsel urged the judge to continue the stay order for the time being as she would approach the Supreme Court

TAKEAWAYS

- » Justice Neena Bansal Krishna also refused to continue the court's interim order asking the trial court not to pass final order on framing of charges in the case which pertains to the alleged larger conspiracy behind the unrest
- » Kalita's counsel urged the judge to continue the stay order for the time being as she would approach the Supreme Court. "I won't be able to do that," Justice Krishna responded

"I won't be able to do that," Justice Krishna responded.

The court, however, allowed a separate petition by Kalita and permitted her to inspect the unrelayed documents in the larger conspiracy case.

Kalita had moved the

high court in 2023, claiming that Delhi Police had commissioned certain persons to record the protests against the Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA) and National Register of Citizens (NRC) in February 2020 and the footage should

- » The court, however, allowed a separate petition by Kalita and permitted her to inspect the unrelayed documents in the larger conspiracy case
- » Kalita had moved the high court in 2023, claiming that Delhi Police had commissioned certain persons to record the protests against Citizenship Amendment Act and National Register of Citizens in Feb 2020 and footage should be supplied to her before the trial court proceeds to hear arguments on framing of charges

be supplied to her before the trial court proceeds to hear the arguments on the framing of charges.

She had contended that the footage would show that she was protesting peacefully.

Besides the video footage,

she had also sought the "entire WhatsApp chat" of a group, "selective extracts" of which were allegedly being used against the petitioner.

On September 12, 2024, the court passed an interim order in the matter and asked the trial court not to pass final order on framing of charges in the case in the alleged larger conspiracy case under anti-terror law UAPA.

Student activists Kalita, Natasha Narwal, Jamia Coordination Committee members Safoora Zargar, former AAP councillor Tahir Hussain and several others have also been booked under various FIRs in relation to the riots in the North-East Delhi, which left 53 people dead and over 700 injured in February 2020.

WORLD ENVIRONMENT DAY

Police plants saplings to boost Delhi green cover

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police marked World Environment Day on Friday with a large-scale tree plantation drive across all its districts and units, reaffirming its commitment to environmental sustainability and a greener capital.

Police Commissioner Satish Golchha led the initiative by planting a sapling at the Police Headquarters. Several senior officers, including Special Commissioners Rajesh Khurana, Garima Bhatnagar, David Lalrinsanga and Dvish Chandra Srivastva, as well as OSD to the Commissioner Sanjay Kumar Jain, participated in the campaign.

Other senior officials,



including Robin Hibb, Manish Kumar Agarwal, Sanjay Tyagi, Vijayanta Goyal Arya, Aalap Patel and S.K. Singh, were also present. Tree plantation activities were carried out across Delhi Police districts and units, with personnel planting saplings at various locations. Officials said the initiative aimed to increase green cover, promote environmental awareness and encourage citizens to adopt sustainable practices for a cleaner and greener Delhi.

World Environment Day, 18 green gifts

Centre, Delhi launch 18 Namo Oxygen Parks; 100 more green hubs planned

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a major push to expand Delhi's green cover and tackle air pollution, the Centre and Delhi government on Friday jointly launched 18 Namo Oxygen Parks across the Capital and announced plans to develop 100 such parks in the coming years. The initiative was unveiled on World Environment Day, with leaders describing it as a significant step towards creating a cleaner, greener and healthier Delhi.

Union Environment Minister Bhopender Yadav, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Union Minister Kirti Vardhan Singh digitally inaugurated the parks during an event at the Namo Oxygen Park in Maidan Garhi, Delhi Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa, South Delhi MP Ramvir Singh Bidhuri and Chhatrapur MLA Kartar Singh Tanwar were also present.

Spread over 185.42 acres, the 18 parks have been designed to increase green cover, improve air quality and promote biodiversity. According to the government, the parks will primarily feature indigenous species such



as peepal, banyan, jamun and mango trees, which provide greater ecological benefits and support local bird habitats.

Addressing the gathering, Bhopender Yadav said, "The 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' campaign launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi has successfully transformed tree plantation into a mass movement linked to gratitude, responsibility and envi-



ronmental awareness." He urged citizens to not only plant saplings but also ensure their survival and growth. CM Rekha Gupta said the government aims to develop 100 Namo Oxygen Parks across Delhi and plant 70 lakh trees and saplings this year. "The previous government had not shown the required seriousness in addressing the growing pollution problem over

the years, whereas the present government has placed environmental protection among its highest priorities," she said. Gupta added that the objective was not merely plantation but ensuring "100 percent survival" through geo-tagging and proper maintenance. "Delhi can become greener and pollution-free if every citizen plants a sapling and takes responsibility

for nurturing it," she said. Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa said the initiative would strengthen Delhi's environmental future through public participation. "Under the visionary leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Delhi is moving rapidly towards development, prosperity and environmental sustainability," he said. The event also

HIGHLIGHTS

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» Union Environment Minister Bhopender Yadav, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Union Minister Kirti Vardhan Singh digitally inaugurated the parks during an event at the Namo Oxygen Park in Maidan Garhi



Monsoon looms, Zakhira Underpass gets a check-up

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: With the monsoon season approaching, the Delhi government has intensified efforts to tackle one of the Capital's most persistent civic problems, waterlogging. As part of the preparedness drive, Water and PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh on Friday inspected the ongoing drainage improvement works at the Zakhira Underpass, a location that has frequently witnessed severe flooding during heavy rains.

During the visit, the minister reviewed the construction of a major RCC drainage network being developed from Rama Road to the Zakhira Flyover on Rohtak Road. Officials informed him that the upgraded system will channel rainwater directly into the Najafgarh Drain, significantly reducing the risk of water accumulation at the underpass and adjoining areas.

Highlighting the government's preparedness, Singh said, "Following the recent spell of rain, all identified waterlogging points across Delhi were inspected by teams from PWD and Delhi Jal Board. Officials have been continuously monitoring the situation and carrying out necessary improvements. Our objective is clear, Delhi residents should not face inconvenience due to waterlogging during the monsoon."

He said the government is focusing on preventive measures instead of waiting for problems to arise during peak rainfall. "There is still time before peak monsoon arrives. We are utilising every day to strengthen infrastructure, improve drainage systems and ensure smooth movement of traffic and citizens. Pump stations have been upgraded, monitoring systems are active, and officials are conducting regular inspections," he said.

According to officials, sev-

“There is still time before peak monsoon arrives. We are utilising every day to strengthen infra, improve drainage systems and ensure smooth movement of traffic and citizens

eral measures have been implemented at Zakhira and other vulnerable locations across the city. These include increasing pumping capacity, creating systems to divert rainwater directly to the Najafgarh Drain, ensuring uninterrupted power supply to pumping stations, and preventing water retention at underpasses.

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi has also been directed to ensure timely desilting and garbage removal so that drains do not get clogged during rains. Coordination between the PWD, Delhi Jal Board and MCD has been strengthened to enable a quicker response during emergencies.

The minister directed officials to maintain strict supervision over ongoing works and ensure they are completed within the stipulated time frame. "Our focus is not limited to Zakhira alone. Every identified waterlogging point in Delhi is being addressed. We are committed to ensuring that roads remain functional, traffic movement remains smooth and citizens do not suffer during the monsoon," Singh said.

The Delhi government has launched a city-wide exercise to identify, monitor and rectify vulnerable locations, with similar preventive works underway across multiple areas ahead of the rainy season.

MCD ACTS against unauthorised setups

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Friday launched demolition and sealing of unauthorised buildings in South Delhi, officials said.

The action comes two days after a devastating blaze at a bed-and-breakfast facility in Hauz Rani area killed 21 people, including several foreign nationals.

According to officials, a demolition exercise has been initiated against unauthorised buildings and establishments in Sultanpur area near MG Road in Khanpur in MCD's South zone. Similar action is likely to be taken up against such structures in Chirag Delhi area.

A demolition drive is also being conducted in some parts of Malviya Nagar.

According to officials, more than 40 properties have been identified for sealing in Saidulajab area over violation of building bye-laws. Besides, at least 12 bed-and-breakfast (B&B) facilities have been in flagged in Hauz Rani and Malviya Nagar areas.

Various commercial establishments, including several restaurants, in Saidulajab, Hauz Khas Village, and nearby South

Delhi areas are also under the scanner.

Amid heavy security deployment, MCD officials on Friday began demolition and sealing of structures found violating building bye-laws and licence conditions, as part of an enforcement drive in parts of South zone.

Officials said a two-storey market complex being constructed on a farmhouse property in Ghitorni area near Sultanpur will be razed as part of the crackdown, as the land use of the property had been illegally changed by the owner. Several luxury outlets were planned to come up in the market complex. "Heavy machinery including excavators have been deployed for the demolition exercise," an official said.

"Two buildings have already been sealed in the Hauz Khas Village, six buildings have been identified in Saidulajab and will be sealed today, and few other buildings will be sealed in nearby areas," a senior MCD official said.

"Identified unauthorised establishments near Hauz Rani area, where the fire incident took place, will be sealed soon; we are waiting for their bed-and-breakfast licences to be revoked," he added.

No more lapses: CM orders crackdown on illegal construction, fire violations...

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Two days after the Malviya Nagar fire tragedy claimed 21 lives, the Delhi government on Friday unveiled an extensive action plan targeting illegal constructions, fire safety violations and administrative negligence, warning officials, builders and property owners of criminal prosecution, financial recovery, sealing drives and strict accountability measures. The decisions were taken at a high-level meeting chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, who declared that no official or private individual found responsible for compromising public safety would be spared.

The meeting was attended by Home and Urban Development Minister Ashish Sood, the Chief Secretary, Delhi Police Commissioner, DDA Vice-Chairman, MCD Commissioner, NDMC Chairman, Divisional Commissioner, all District Magistrates, Municipal Deputy Commissioners and senior officials from various departments.

Briefing reporters after the meeting, Sood said the government's objective was not merely to react to a tragedy but to create a permanent mechanism to pre-



vent such incidents. "The government's objective is not merely to take immediate action but to establish a foolproof system that can permanently prevent such incidents in the future," he said.

One of the most significant decisions was to initiate action against negligent officials under the Disaster Management Act, 2005, which provides for imprisonment of up to two years and financial penalties. Officials whose negligence, corruption or collusion allows illegal constructions, fire safety violations or hazardous activities to continue may also face proceedings under the Prevention of Corruption Act.

The government further decided that losses suffered due to negligence would be recovered under the Revenue Recovery Act, 1890. According

to Sood, compensation would no longer remain confined to paperwork. Salaries, pensions and properties of guilty officials could be attached, while bank accounts and movable and immovable assets of builders, colonisers and owners found responsible could also be frozen and recovered from.

The Chief Minister directed that adverse remarks be recorded in the Annual Performance Appraisal Reports (APARs) of negligent officials, affecting their future career prospects. She stressed that accountability would extend beyond junior staff and include senior officers as well.

To tackle what the government described as fragmented administrative authority, District Magistrates will be given enhanced powers to fix account-

ability across departments, initiate disciplinary proceedings, order registration of FIRs, approve or cancel leave and take immediate action against erring officials.

The government also expressed concern over frequent transfers in building departments. Junior Engineers, Assistant Engineers and other officials will be required to provide a complete account of construction activities and permissions issued during their tenure before transfer. Officials will continue to be held accountable for actions taken in previous postings. In a major policy shift, the government directed the development of a third-party insurance mechanism for guest houses, buildings, nursing homes and public-use premises. The Chief Minister said insurance companies would provide coverage only after verifying structural safety, creating additional pressure for compliance.

To improve transparency in emergency response, the government will develop a digital system that records the complete timeline of fire incidents, from receipt of a distress call to the arrival of firefighting teams at the scene.

Sharp drop in max, min temps

NEW DELHI: The national capital saw a sharp drop in the maximum and minimum temperatures on Friday, after parts of the city received light to moderate rain in the early hours of the day due to a western disturbance. Safdarjung, the city's base weather station, saw a drop of 3.7 degrees in the minimum temperature, which settled at 26 degrees Celsius. The maximum temperature was recorded at 35.8 degrees Celsius, 4.2 degrees below the normal.

Safdarjung also recorded 0.1 mm of rain between 2.30 am and 5.30 am on Friday. No further rain was recorded after that till 5.30 pm on Friday, as per data from the IMD.

Other weather stations also showed a similar drop in the temperature. Palam recorded a minimum temperature of 22 degrees Celsius, 6.2 degrees below the normal. The maximum at Palam was 35.6 degrees Celsius, 5.4 degrees below the normal.



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta inaugurates the Coforge Library in Delhi on Friday. The facility aims to promote reading, learning and knowledge-sharing, particularly among young readers

TARGETS 10,000 EV CABS IN NCR WITHIN A YEAR

Delhi flags off 1K electric taxis

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: On World Environment Day, the Delhi government launched a major clean mobility initiative by flagging off 1,000 app-based electric taxis across Delhi-NCR, with plans to scale the fleet to 10,000 vehicles within a year. The service, operated by Vietnam-based Green SM, was launched from the Delhi Secretariat by Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa and Transport Minister Dr. Pankaj Kumar Singh.

The launch also marked the introduction of the Green SM mobile application. Senior company officials, including Global CEO Nguyen Van Thanh and Vingroup Asia CEO Pham Sanh Chau, attended the event.

Highlighting the government's commitment to envi-



ronmental sustainability, Sirsa said, "Under the leadership of Hon'ble Chief Minister Smt. Rekha Gupta Ji, the Delhi Government is committed to promoting green initiatives that help reduce pollution and improve the quality of life of citizens. Whether it is large-scale plantation drives, cleaner technologies or the adoption of electric mobility, every step contributes towards building a healthier Delhi."

Transport Minister Dr. Pankaj Kumar Singh said the initiative aligns with Delhi's broader clean transport goals. "Electric mobility is a key pillar of Delhi's vision for sustainable urban transport and aligns with the objectives of the Delhi EV Policy to accelerate the adoption of clean mobility solutions, reduce vehicular emissions, and improve air quality. Every step towards electrification is a step towards a healthier environment

and a better quality of life for our citizens," he said.

Sirsa also underscored the significance of the project under the Make in India initiative. "These vehicles are a shining example of the Make in India initiative and strengthen the vision of Atmanirbhar Bharat. Manufactured in India, they showcase the country's growing manufacturing strength and technological prowess while creating a cleaner and more sustainable transportation ecosystem," he said.

Green SM has established a manufacturing facility in Tamil Nadu and invested in India through the FDI route. The electric cabs are equipped with AI-assisted interior and exterior cameras, real-time monitoring systems and SOS buttons for passengers and drivers.

Government to invoke DDMA Act

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government will recover losses from officials found guilty of corruption and will invoke DDMA, Home Minister Ashish Sood said on Friday, days after a massive fire killed 21 people at a south Delhi hotel erected with little regard to building norms. The decision to invoke the Delhi Disaster Management Act 2005 was taken at a meeting held by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta with several departments.

"Delhi government to invoke DDMA Act to enforce two-year-jail on violations of orders, action against officers for complicity. Under this act, there are provisions to recover losses from officers' salary, pension, even their properties," Sood said.

Armed women cops on buses: L-G's safety push

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Tarunjit Singh Sandhu has stressed that safe travel for women should be ensured in public transport as well as till their last destinations from the transit bus stops and stations, Lok Niwas officials said on Friday.

Chairing a meeting on Thursday to review women's safety in public transport, Sandhu emphasised that the deployment of female armed police personnel in Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) buses will ensure security for women passengers and asked the transport department to approach the Delhi Police for the same.

Sandhu underlined that safety and security of women passengers should not only be ensured while they were travelling inside the DTC buses and other modes of public transport, but also to their doorsteps once they have de-boarded at the stations, depots or bus stands.

For this purpose, the L-G directed the officials to onboard cab and auto aggregators and e-rickshaws and deployment of female armed police personnel in the buses, officials said.

Secretary-cum-Commis-

sioner (Transport), Managing Director, DTC and other senior officers of Transport department were present in the meeting.

Rollout of Pink Smart Card initiative, status of CCTV and panic button deployments, operations of the control centre, bus marshal, and women's participation in bus operations were reviewed in the meeting.

Acknowledging the department's successful rollout of the Saheli Pink Smart Card, Sandhu stressed the need to make the card usable in all modes of public transport to ensure seamless travel for women passengers.

He emphasised leveraging the current operational baseline of 1,002 women conductors and 77 women drivers to further expand female recruitment across public transport fleets.

The department was also asked to focus especially on electric vehicles as last-mile connectivity options to reach remote areas, peripheral pockets, and unserved neighbourhoods in the city.

Sandhu also emphasised the need to introduce and encourage carpooling initiatives only for women, by onboarding private aggregators like Uber, Ola, Bharat Taxi and Rapido.

Hosp: 6 still on ventilator after Delhi hotel fire

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Six patients injured in the recent hotel fire in south Delhi remain on ventilator support, though all of them are stable and showing signs of improvement, Max Hospital in Saket said on Friday.

Sources added that the six patients are foreign nationals. The hospital said a total of 15 patients are currently admitted at its Saket complex, of whom 13 are international patients.

According to the hospital, nine patients are admitted in the ICU and wards, and the overall condition of all those undergoing treatment remains stable.

The hospital further said that two injured international patients were brought to its emergency department from another hospital on June 3, the day of the fire incident.

Both patients were discharged on the evening of June 4, it said.

"All admitted patients are recovering, and the hospital continues to provide comprehensive medical care and regular monitoring to ensure the best possible outcomes," the hospital said in a statement.

Twenty-one people were killed and several others injured after a massive fire broke out at a hotel in Delhi's Hauz Rani area on Wednesday.

AMERICAN AMBASSADOR MET SEVERAL IMPORTANT PERSONALITIES

Washington seeks stronger India ties across innovation, trade and security

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: The visit of the US Under Secretary of State for Public Diplomacy Sarah B Rogers to India has once again highlighted Washington's growing strategic focus on New Delhi.

Coming amid a series of high-level diplomatic engagements, the visit underscores the United States' efforts to deepen cooperation with India in critical sectors ranging from technology and innovation to trade, agriculture, and intellectual property, reflecting the expanding scope of a partnership increasingly shaped by shared geopolitical and economic interests.

One of the major highlights of the visit was when Rogers and newly appointed US envoy Sergio Gor visited the prestigious Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi

Highlights

» The visit underscores the United States' efforts to deepen cooperation with India in critical sectors

» TRUST aims to utilise the unique advantages of both nations in the fields of science and technology, medicine, innovation, and talent development

and participated in discussions. Wherein almost 300 people representing academia, industry, and the media participated, and the two leaders stressed the need to expedite research commercialisation under the Transforming the Relationship Utilising Strategic Technology (TRUST) programme.

TRUST aims to utilise the

unique advantages of both nations in the fields of science and technology, medicine, innovation, and talent development.

Rogers stated that collaboration between the US and India in advanced technological research is critical for ensuring that India remains a trustworthy partner of the United States for scientific collaborations of a highly secure nature while simultaneously fostering mutual trade and talent exchange.

Apart from science, innovation, and technology, Rogers' visit to India also included a people-to-people aspect of public diplomacy.

The American Ambassador met several important personalities in New Delhi through his interactions at the American Centre.

They include a roundtable on submarine cable infrastruc-

ture, during which she made a case for the use of trusted technology suppliers to ensure that global data systems are protected against any security threats and political tensions.

In addition to meeting with past participants in exchange programs sponsored by the US government, she stressed the need for maintaining a free and resilient Indo-Pacific.

One more significant occasion was a roundtable on intellectual property law, organised together with the showing of the movie "Jailhouse Rock", with the participation of representatives of the US Patent and Trademark Office as well as YouTube Music.

It demonstrates that Washington still regards intellectual property protection as an essential aspect of economic collaboration.

This visit also aimed to foster agricultural exports via a

demonstration called "Taste of America", featuring products like pecans and poultry, thus demonstrating the increasing importance of agricultural trade within the framework of economic cooperation.

This tour ended with Rogers' attendance at a Freedom 250 function that saw the participation of prominent figures from business, media, alumni groups, and civil society.

This was done with a view to reaffirming the USA's resolve to forge and strengthen its multi-faceted relationship with India in the decades to come.

All said and done, it must be noted that the current American policy towards India is one of strengthening bilateral cooperation with New Delhi in critical areas, thereby underlining the importance of the partnership from a geopolitical and economic perspective for both the USA and India.

Gilgit-Baltistan elections reignite India-Pakistan sovereignty dispute

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: A strong objection has been filed by India, on Friday, to Pakistan with respect to its move to conduct 'General Elections' for the 'Gilgit-Baltistan Assembly' in areas which India says belong to it "illegally and forcibly." These elections are expected to take place on June 7.

The Ministry of External Affairs of India reiterated, in its statement, its position that "...the entire Union Territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh, including Gilgit-Baltistan, are integral and inalienable parts of India by virtue of the complete, legal and irrevocable accession of the erstwhile princely state of Jammu and Kashmir to India in 1947."

The Indian government said that the efforts made by Pakistan in an attempt to conduct elections in the region did not change the status of the region, nor would it make the occupation of the region by Pakistan legal. The government pointed out that these measures were designed to hide the truth about the reality of human rights abuse and political oppression in the Pakistani-con-

These elections are expected to take place on June 7

trolled regions.

New Delhi also sternly turned down any attempt on the part of Islamabad to make any change to the situation on the ground. Reiterating its standpoint, India made it clear that what Pakistan was doing could not hide the reality that it had been occupying India's territory illegally and asked Pakistan to quit the territories under its illegal occupation. This is the latest development in a series of disputes between the two nations regarding Jammu and Kashmir and other territorial issues. "...such actions cannot hide the fact that Pakistan illegally remains in possession of Indian territories, which it must vacate," the Indian government stated.

The conflict involving India and Pakistan regarding Gilgit-Baltistan is based on conflicting claims by both countries with respect to the formerly ruled princely state of Jammu and Kashmir. India holds the view that Gil-

git-Baltistan is a territory that is inextricably bound up with the rest of its territories, basing its claim on the legal accession of the previous state of Jammu and Kashmir to India in 1947. However, Pakistan rules the territory but views it as disputed land, ruling it separately from the rest of Pakistan.

The issue causes diplomatic conflicts at regular intervals, especially whenever Pakistan introduces any political or administrative change in the region, including conducting assembly elections or implementing changes to its governance system.

New Delhi has also voiced fears about violations of human rights and political oppression, along with economic exploitation in the region. Apart from being politically significant, Gilgit-Baltistan also has much strategic importance due to its position at the entrance of the China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC), an important initiative undertaken by China to connect itself to the Arabian Sea. India has been opposing CPEC projects in the region as it believes that they violate its territorial sovereignty.

From Page 1

India beats

January-March quarter, the data released by MoSPI showed. "Real GDP or GDP at constant prices is estimated to attain a level of Rs 323.12 lakh crore in the 2025-26, against the First Revised Estimate (FRE) of GDP for the year 2024-25 of Rs 299.89 lakh crore," according to the data released by National Statistic Office (NSO).

The nominal GDP or GDP at current prices is estimated to attain a level of Rs 346.36 lakh crore in 2025-26, against Rs 318.07 lakh crore in 2024-25, showing a growth rate of 8.9 per cent.

This is the second set of GDP data in the new series with 2022-23 as the base year.

Commenting on the data, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said the government is committed to further drive the "reform express" with decisive policy measures to ensure positive economic momentum amidst the global challenges.

NSO further said GDP at constant prices in January-March quarter of 2025-26 is estimated at Rs 87.77 lakh crore, against Rs 81.40 lakh crore in the year-ago period, a growth of 7.8 per cent.

NSO said secondary and tertiary sectors have boosted the performance of the economy by registering growths of 8.8 per cent and 9.3 per cent, respectively, during FY26.

These sectors include construction, manufacturing, trade, hotels, transport, communication and services related to broadcasting, storage, and financial, real estate, IT, professional services and ownership of dwelling.

The primary sector registered 3.2 per cent growth rate mainly driven by the performance of agriculture and fishery sectors. "Agriculture, livestock, forestry and fishing" segment grew at 3.6 per cent in the fourth quarter compared to 4.6 per cent. During 2025-26, the growth was 3.1 per cent.

On the expenditure side, both private final consumption expenditure (PFCE) and gross fixed capital formation (GFCF) registered over 7.5 per cent expansion during 2025-26.

The gross value added (GVA) has been estimated at Rs 294.91 lakh crore in 2025-26, against Rs 273.36 lakh crore in 2024-25, registering a growth rate of 7.9 per cent as against 7.3 per cent in the preceding year.

The GVA in the fourth quarter of FY26 was Rs 80.18 lakh crore against Rs 74.32 lakh crore in the year-ago period, registering a growth of 7.9 per cent.

As per data, in FY26, the manufacturing sector was the best-performing sector, registering growth of 10.7 per cent. The manufacturing sector registered growth at a higher rate than that of the services sector, which is influenced by government infrastructure spending, production incentives, and industrialisation.

The service sector, which represents the largest contribution to economic output, grew at 9.3 per cent, with growth coming from transport, finance and other digital economy activities. Growth in agriculture stood at 3 per cent,

representing an improvement from last year's growth.

Investments were especially positive. Gross Fixed Capital Formation - an indicator of investments, rose by 10.8 per cent in the last quarter of FY26, which is a much higher figure compared to GDP growth. In the same period, Private Final Consumption Expenditure, indicating household expenditure, increased by 7.1 per cent.

The government also highlighted that India faces a problem due to several factors associated with both supply and demand. Starting from the beginning of the conflict, the Indian oil basket rose by 40.5 per cent, while Brent Crude grew by 39.5 per cent.

Putin

enter service with the Indian Air Force before 2035, the government is examining options to bridge the capability gap. One proposal under consideration involves procuring at least two squadrons, approximately 36 aircraft, of the Su-57, provided the platform meets the required technical specifications.

Putin also indicated that Russia is interested in collaborating with India on air defence technologies and related military systems.

"The same goes for the air defence system," he said, noting that Moscow was prepared to work with India on the development of advanced air defence capabilities.

India is currently developing an indigenous air defence network known as Sudarshan Chakra. Russian-origin S-400 missile systems are expected to play a significant role within that framework.

In 2018, India signed a USD 5 billion agreement with Russia for five units of the S-400 air defence missile system despite warnings from the United States that the purchase could trigger sanctions under the Countering America's Adversaries Through Sanctions Act (CAATSA). While four squadrons have been delivered, the fifth remains pending.

The S-400 system gained renewed attention following its role during Operation Sindoor. Earlier this year, New Delhi approved the acquisition of five additional S-400 systems from Russia, which would raise the total number to ten.

According to the Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI), India was the world's second-largest importer of arms and military equipment between 2021 and 2025, with Russia remaining the country's biggest supplier.

Responding separately in New Delhi to questions about Putin's remarks, External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said India and Russia continued to share strong defence relations.

"You mentioned the Su-57; the defence ties between India and Russia are strong. For this programme, you will be able to get specific details from the Ministry of Defence," he said.

Beyond defence cooperation, Putin devoted considerable attention to the broader India-Russia relationship. He praised India's economic performance and credited Modi's government for driving the country's growth.

"India is one of the leading economies of the world that has showed the highest rate of eco-

nommic growth. This is not something that comes out of the blue. This is result of the hard work that the government of India has been doing under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi," Putin said.

The Russian leader said bilateral trade, currently around USD 60 billion annually, could rise substantially in the coming years.

"We hope that in upcoming years, we will reach USD 100 billion in mutual trade. We have all the foundations to work more actively and to reach more ambitious goals," he said.

Putin identified hydrocarbons, pharmaceuticals and clean energy as sectors that could help drive the next phase of economic cooperation.

He also strongly defended India's right to pursue an independent foreign policy, pushing back against Western efforts to persuade New Delhi to reduce engagement with Moscow.

"Everyone has understood that putting pressure on Prime Minister Narendra Modi (and India) that has the largest population in the world, is detrimental for international relations and for bilateral relations. It doesn't matter where this pressure comes from," Putin said.

Calling India a reliable strategic partner, he said Russia had not experienced any negative consequences from New Delhi's relationships with other countries, including the United States.

"We are glad that India is developing its relations with all the countries. It's a great country, a large economy, the largest democracy," he said, adding that India naturally conducts its foreign policy according to its national interests.

Putin also addressed regional issues, including relations between India and China. Describing the relationship as "delicate" and complex, he said Russia would not interfere in bilateral matters between the two Asian powers.

"President Xi and Prime Minister Modi are both trying to resolve all the issues of mutual interest, including the border issue," he said.

The Russian president noted that Moscow's ties with India and China had evolved independently and naturally over decades.

"Relations between Russia and India do not disturb China, our relations with China do not disturb India," he said.

Referring to India-Pakistan relations, Putin said Russia understood the complexities surrounding the border issues between the two neighbours. Asked whether Pakistan was under China's influence, he replied, "I don't think so," describing Pakistan as a large country with diverse international partnerships, while acknowledging the importance of China-Pakistan cooperation.

Putin is expected to visit India again in September to attend the BRICS summit, a trip that will provide another opportunity for the two countries to advance discussions on defence, trade and strategic cooperation amid shifting global geopolitical dynamics.

Annamalai

Amit Shah in Delhi earlier this week, said his departure came after amicable discussions with senior BJP leaders. While express-

ing respect for Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the BJP leadership, he maintained that his political goals required a different path. "From today onwards, a new path, a new movement; a new political movement," he said, adding that the initiative would focus on "common man politics" and move away from what he described as cult politics, sycophancy and hereditary leadership.

He said the movement would be built gradually, with an emphasis on nurturing leaders and cadres before formally expanding into a full-fledged political party. "Let's change ourselves, and change will happen naturally," he said, describing the movement's guiding slogan as "maruvom, maatruvom" (let's change, let's bring change).

The former state BJP chief clarified that his organisation was not being launched to oppose any particular party. He said it would present its own policies while respecting the presence of established political parties including the DMK, AIADMK and others.

Annamalai also announced the launch of wetheleader.org, a platform aimed at connecting volunteers and supporters. According to his team, more than 8.09 lakh people had enrolled as volunteers on the website by Friday. He further unveiled plans to establish the APJ Abdul Kalam Centre for Ethics and Politics in Coimbatore.

Outlining his political vision, Annamalai proposed term limits for elected representatives and called for strengthening local governance. He said no political position should be permanent and suggested limiting the number of terms individuals could serve as MLAs or MPs.

Reflecting on his tenure as Tamil Nadu BJP president, Annamalai said he had never compromised on issues related to the state's identity, culture and water rights. He also asserted that he would continue to balance his identity as both a Tamilian and an Indian. His resignation drew mixed reactions. Tamil Nadu BJP president Nainar Nagenthiran said Annamalai's exit would not affect the party. "There will be no loss to the BJP due to his resignation," he told reporters, adding that anyone was free to start a political party in a democracy.

However, BJP state vice-president Karu Nagarajan announced that he would resign from the party and support Annamalai's new movement. "We have decided to support Annamalai, who is an energetic and bold leader," he said.

Abhilash Gopinath, the BJP Yuva Morcha's state legal convenor, also resigned, saying Annamalai's leadership and integrity had inspired his political journey.

Supporters celebrated the announcement by bursting firecrackers and distributing sweets, while leaders from other parties reacted cautiously. MDMK leader Durai Vaiko welcomed the move and wished Annamalai success in his new political endeavour.

Annamalai rose to prominence through an aggressive political style that frequently targeted the ruling DMK and often generated controversy. After stepping down as state BJP chief in April 2025 following the return of the BJP-AIADMK alliance, speculation had intensified over his future political plans. Friday's announcement confirmed those expectations and set the stage for a new political chapter in Tamil Nadu.

India, US aim

lower tariffs on Indian goods to 18 per cent from 50 per cent and remove a 25 per cent tariff linked to India's purchases of Russian oil. The remaining 25 per cent duty was also to be reduced to 18 per cent. However, the trade landscape changed after the US Supreme Court ruled against President Donald Trump's reciprocal tariffs imposed under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act. Following the ruling, the US announced a uniform 10 per cent tariff on imports from all countries for 150 days beginning February 24 and ending July 24. The change has prompted both sides to reassess the earlier framework. A clause in the February agreement allows either country to modify its commitments if tariff arrangements change.

India had proposed reducing or eliminating duties on US industrial goods and several agricultural products, including dried distillers' grains, red sorghum, tree nuts, fruits, soybean oil, wine and spirits. New Delhi also expressed plans to purchase goods worth USD 500 billion from the US over five years, including energy products, aircraft, technology goods, precious metals and coking coal. Meanwhile, trade negotiations are taking place amid fresh US scrutiny under Section 301 investigations. On June 2, the US Trade Representative proposed a 12.5 per cent tariff on imports from 54 countries, including India, over concerns related to forced labour. The proposal is not yet final, with hearings scheduled for July 7.

The US remained India's second-largest trading partner in 2025-26. India's exports to the US rose 0.92 per cent to USD 87.3 billion, while imports increased 15.95 per cent to USD 52.9 billion. India's trade surplus with the US narrowed to USD 34.4 billion from USD 40.89 billion in the previous fiscal year.

Lalu Yadav, Rabri

eight BSAP house guards, two bodyguards from the Patna District Force, along with a pilot vehicle and a bulletproof car.

The government has also withdrawn the Y-category security cover of Janshakti Janta Dal chief Tej Pratap, Lalu Prasad's elder son. Meanwhile, Y-plus security for Leader of Opposition Tejashwi Yadav remains unchanged. The notification said existing security arrangements for MP Misa Bharti and Rajshree Yadav, Tejashwi Yadav's wife, will also continue.

SC orders

The apex court sought responses from the Centre, Assam government and others on all these pleas and posted them for hearing on July 16. When one of the advocates appearing for the petitioners said the petitioners may be deported, the bench said, "In the meantime, status quo, as it exists today, shall be maintained."

AGENCIES

India launches

to him, the programme has saved more than Rs 1.84 lakh crore in foreign exchange and reduced crude oil imports by nearly 302 lakh metric tonnes.

He said wider adoption of E85 could help increase the country's overall ethanol blending level to nearly 26 per cent by 2030-31. Ministry estimates show that flex-fuel vehicles running on E85 can cut lifecycle greenhouse gas emissions by around 61 per cent compared with conventional petrol vehicles.

Puri said if half of all new two-wheelers and passenger vehicles sold in India adopt flex-fuel technology, annual ethanol demand could rise by over 312 crore litres. Such a shift could generate about Rs 12,403 crore in additional income for farmers, save roughly Rs 15,151 crore in foreign exchange each year and reduce carbon dioxide emissions by 66.4 lakh metric tonnes.

Drawing a comparison with Brazil, where more than 80 per cent of light vehicles use flex-fuel technology, Puri said India was building a national flex-fuel ecosystem. He added that no engine failures linked to ethanol blending had been reported since E20 became the national standard fuel. "Every litre of ethanol replaces imported fossil fuel," he said. "Every drop of E85 carries the spirit of an Atmanirbhar Bharat."

Deportations

of the concerned nation, then only does the process of deportation take place."

According to Jaiswal, there are specific laws and processes involved when carrying out the process of deportation, and it was done in an organised manner. These statements made by him were in the wake of allegations against India made by Bangladesh regarding illegal deportations.

According to the senior official, there are several nationality verification requests which have been made to the Bangladesh authority, and many of them are yet to be processed. The spokesperson also hoped that Bangladesh would make the process faster and thus solve the cases concerning illegal migrants.

This has become an issue which has cropped up between the two countries in recent times, with Bangladesh alleging a practice of "push-in" across some parts of their shared border. India was reported to have made several attempts to deport undocumented immigrants to Bangladesh recently. Such actions have raised tensions between the two neighbouring nations.

In a statement by the Border Guard Bangladesh (BGB), it has been claimed that there have been 10 cases of attempts in a single day. Dhaka stated its apprehension regarding returning people without going through proper repatriation procedures.

It has been emphasised by the BGB that anyone who is found to be a citizen of Bangladesh in India must be deported using proper channels as per the bilateral understanding.

But India has stated that it has a well-defined deportation procedure in place, and repatriation cannot be done until nationality verification is done by the receiving country.

India shares a border which is

around 4,100 km long with Bangladesh, which is one of the longest borders in the world. Cooperation in the field of migration is a very important aspect of India-Bangladesh relations. According to New Delhi, the matter of illegal migration is a question of enforcing the law.

This development is occurring against the backdrop of heightened sensitivity due to recent developments within Bangladesh's internal politics and India's efforts to tackle the problem of illegal immigration. Although Bangladesh has expressed its worries about the situation, India claims that the process of deportation is a legal one involving the verification of nationality in the country of reception before deportation.

It will undoubtedly be at the forefront of talks between both countries in New Delhi on several issues related to border management and migration.

Jaipur: Ugandan woman quarantined after showing Ebola-like symptoms

OUR CORRESPONDENT

JAIPUR: A 19-year-old woman from Uganda has been admitted to a government hospital here after showing symptoms similar to Ebola virus infection, health officials said on Friday, adding that they have not confirmed the disease so far.

Officials said the woman arrived in Jaipur earlier in the day as a tourist from Sharjah on an Air Arabia flight and was flagged as a suspected case during screening at the airport by a medical team from the state health department.

They said she has been admitted to the Rajasthan University of Health Sciences (RUHS) hospital and kept in isolation in a critical care block.

RUHS Principal Dr Moh-nish Grover said a sample from the patient has been sent to Pune for testing, while a second sample will be sent after 48 hours.

The patient will remain in quarantine until the test results are available, he said.

"If the test returns positive, she will be kept under quarantine for 21 days and treated accordingly," he said.

RUHS Hospital Superintendent Dr Anil Gupta said the woman has not been diagnosed with Ebola so far and only symptoms resembling the infection have been observed.

"Ebola cannot be confirmed based on symptoms alone," he said.

According to officials, the woman has a medical history of abdominal pain and loss of appetite for about a month. At present, she is also complaining of a headache.

Health authorities advised passengers who travelled with her on the same flight to remain in home isolation as a precautionary measure.

Authorities are closely monitoring the situation and following all prescribed protocols.

'PEOPLE ANGER FORCED CONG TO CHANGE KARNATAKA CM'

Cong seeks to cash in by creating chaos: PM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

SURAT: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday said “immense public anger” forced the Congress to change its CM in Karnataka and accused the party of spreading chaos and uncertainty in the last 12 years and seeking political and electoral opportunities in them.

He noted the current decade is proving to be a period of crises for the world and referred to the COVID-9 pandemic, wars and now energy crisis in the wake of the West Asia conflict, but asserted India faced each of these challenges with strength and resilience through the collective efforts of its 140 crore citizens.

He was addressing a gathering in Surat after inaugurating and laying foundation stones



Prime Minister Narendra Modi addresses the inauguration and laying of foundation stones of various development projects, in Surat district, Gujarat

for development projects of Rs 18,000 crore in Gujarat.

Modi said the ongoing global crisis highlights just how crucial energy self-reliance is, and underscores the importance of the capacity the country has built over the past 12 years, and targeted the Opposition

for constantly mocking his government's 'Atmanirbhar Bharat' initiative.

The Prime Minister pointed out that voters have repeatedly given mandate to the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) as they trust his government's development initiatives and growth-driven

Highlights

- » Modi said the ongoing global crisis highlights just how crucial energy self-reliance is
- » PM pointed out that voters have repeatedly given mandate to BJP as they trust his gov't development initiatives

agenda for the country.

This was reflected in the massive mandate the BJP-led NDA received in the recent elections in West Bengal, Assam, and Puducherry, and in panchayat and municipal corporation polls taking place across the country, he stated.

“Every election conveys the same message: the nation does not like anarchy, uncertainty, or despair. For the past 12 years, the Congress has been seeking opportunities amidst the chaos and uncertainty it has spread, yet the people of the country have repeatedly given it a fitting reply,” he added.

Modi said the people of Gujarat have pushed the Congress to the margins, and even in states where it is in power, the public is fed up with its misgovernance, citing the results of local body polls held recently in Himachal Pradesh, Haryana and Punjab.

People in these states have delivered a clear message, that the Congress's politics of seeking opportunity amidst chaos will not work, Modi insisted.

“People are unhappy wherever the Congress party is in

power. There is also immense public anger regarding the Congress government in Karnataka; that is precisely why the party had to replace its Chief Minister there,” he said, referring to DK Shivakumar taking over as the CM replacing Siddharamaiah in the southern state on June 3.

“India has moved far beyond negativity. It is a nation of boundless optimism and extraordinary aspirations,” he emphasised.

Modi affirmed his government worked to build capacity over the past 12 years to make India self-reliant in energy, and the ongoing global crisis has only highlighted this.

“On one hand, we secured oil and gas supplies from various parts of the world and on the other, we ramped up historic investments in renewable energy,” he told the gathering.

CBSE made to adopt OSM system at inflated rates: Cong

Pushes for Pradhan's resignation

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Friday said that only Education minister Dharmendra Pradhan can answer as to why the CBSE was “made to adopt an expensive OSM system at inflated rates”, and asserted that he must resign so that an independent investigation can take place.



Dharmendra Pradhan

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh said the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) Governing Body in its December 2024 meeting flagged that the ‘financial implications of implementing On-Screen Marking (OSM)’ are ‘substantially high’ compared to existing practices.

Citing a report in an English daily, Ramesh said it reveals that the estimated contract value of the CBSE's tender for the OSM system increased by Rs 10 crore for the same volume of work.

“It was Rs 28 crore in the first two tenders issued by the CBSE but rose to Rs 38.46 crore in the final work order issued to COEMPT,” he alleged.

was made to adopt an expensive OSM system at inflated rates, despite the Governing Body's concerns about the cost,” Ramesh stated.

“Pradhan must resign so that an independent investigation can occur into CBSE. Otherwise, the one-member committee set up by the Modi Government will remain an eyewash,” the Congress leader added.

The Congress has dubbed the government's move to shunt out two top CBSE officials following the on-screen marking system row as an eye-wash and cover-up, with Rahul Gandhi demanding that Pradhan be sacked and an independent judicial inquiry be ordered immediately.

Ramesh pointed out that based on the actual price for the number of answer sheets scanned, the work's value should only be around Rs 25.39 crore, which is approximately 66 per cent of the amount stated in the work order.

The CBSE was unable to answer the procurement-related questions posed by the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Education after it heard from 18-year-old whistle-blower Sarthak Sidhant in its meeting on Tuesday, he said.

“That is because only one man, the Mantri Pradhan, can speak to how and why the CBSE

The CBSE chairman Rahul Singh and secretary Himanshu Gupta were removed from their positions in the national educational board following allegations of irregularities in the digital evaluation system for the Class 12 examination process.

The CBSE has been embroiled in controversy after some Class 12 students claimed that the scanned copies of their answer sheets, uploaded by the board, did not match their handwriting, raising concerns about potential mismatches in the OSM system.

'JEE-Advanced data breach claims misleading, factually incorrect'

NEW DELHI: Claims of a data breach and privacy violation affecting lakhs of JEE (Advanced) aspirants are “misleading and factually incorrect”, the IIT-Roorkee said on Friday, asserting that no sensitive information was compromised or mass-extracted following a temporary cloud-storage misconfiguration.

The Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), Roorkee, which conducted the exam this year, said the information circulating on social media “does not accurately reflect what happened” and alleged an attempt to spread misinformation.

The JEE (Advanced) is the gateway for admission to undergraduate programmes in the IITs and several other premier engineering institutions across the country.

The Ministry of Education

IIT-Roorkee said information circulating on social media 'does not accurately reflect what happened'

also dismissed reports of a data breach and privacy violations involving JEE (Advanced) candidates as “misleading and factually incorrect”.

“There have been several incorrect misleading and factually incorrect reports regarding data breach and privacy violations with respect to students who took JEE (Advanced) examination,” the ministry said in a post on X. “As per the clarification issued by @iitroorkee the Ministry reiterates that no sensitive

information was compromised, and the examination outcomes, marks, and candidate information remain completely secure, intact, and safe,” it added.

“Claims of a data breach and privacy violation affecting lakhs of JEE (Advanced) aspirants are misleading and factually incorrect. The information circulating on social media is misleading and does not accurately reflect what happened. There is an attempt at spreading misinformation, which is far from the truth,” the IIT-Roorkee said in a series of posts on X.

According to the institute, certain technical interventions were undertaken on an expedited basis on June 2 to assist candidates facing difficulties in accessing admit-card data and to ensure the smooth functioning of the registration process.

'EK PED MAA KE NAAM' On World Environment Day, Yogi launches mega plantation drive

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Friday launched the 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' mega plantation campaign and unveiled a series of environment-focused initiatives, including India's first Air Shed-based Clean Air Management Project, on the occasion of World Environment Day.

Addressing a gathering after planting a camphor sapling at the Kukrail Range of the Awadh Forest Division, Adityanath urged every citizen to plant a tree in their mother's name, saying mothers hold the most special place in everyone's life.

“Prime Minister Narendra Modi had reminded citizens of their responsibility towards



Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath waters a sapling during an event on the occasion of 'World Environment Day', in Lucknow

their mother and motherland. That is why the 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' campaign has been dedicated to mothers. Since a

mother is dearest to everyone, every citizen should plant a tree in her name and contribute to this campaign,” he said.

The chief minister also established the Maharshi Charak Medicinal Forest during the programme. More than 200 saplings were planted simultaneously in his presence. Forest minister Arun Kumar Saxena planted an amla sapling, Minister of State for Forests KP Malik planted a neem sapling and BJP MLA OP Srivastava also planted an amla sapling.

Highlighting environmental challenges, the chief minister said climate change has resulted in erratic weather patterns, excessive rainfall and droughts, affecting both humans and nature.

Voters of Himachal highly aware: CEC Gyanesh Kumar

OUR CORRESPONDENT

DHARAMSHALA/NEW DELHI: Voters of Himachal Pradesh are highly aware and discerning and reflect the state's strong democratic traditions, Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar said on Friday.

Kumar on Friday reached Dharamshala as part of his four-day visit to Kangra and Chamba districts till June 8.

He held an interaction with booth-level officers (BLO), their supervisors, and election personnel at a programme in Dharamshala.

Kumar described BLOs and BLO supervisors as the backbone of India's electoral system and lauded their contribution in maintaining accurate, reliable, and inclusive electoral rolls.

RAJYA SABHA POLLS Cong candidate Praveen Chakravarty files nomination with TVK support

OUR CORRESPONDENT

CHENNAI: Backed by the ruling TVK, Congress leader Praveen Chakravarty on Friday filed his nomination papers for the upcoming Rajya Sabha elections in Tamil Nadu.

His claim of support from an alliance, not formally announced earlier, consisting of “TVK, Congress, VCK, Left parties and IUML”, was immediately disputed by VCK and left leaders.

Chakravarty filed his papers in the presence of Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay and several state ministers.

Speaking to reporters after filing his papers, Chakravarty expressed gratitude for the opportunity.

“I will work hard to

The claim of support from an alliance, not formally announced earlier, consisting of 'TVK, Congress, VCK, Left parties and IUML', was immediately disputed by VCK and left leaders

raise my voice in Parliament to protect the rights of Tamil Nadu. I will also ensure that the policies and administrative achievements of the Congress-TVK coalition government in Tamil Nadu are prominently highlighted and championed in the Rajya Sabha,” he said.

Separately, in a post on X, he said, “I feel both proud and responsible to be picked as the first MP candidate of ‘Tamil Nadu Social Justice Progressive (TVK+INC+VCK+IUML+CPI+CPM) Alliance’. Hearty Thanks to Rahul Gandhi and Tamil Nadu CM Vijay for reposing faith in me. I assure lakhs of coalition cadres that I will speak as a bold, loyal and honest voice of the Tamil people in Parliament”.

This post created ripples in political circles, as no such alliance was formally announced by those parties earlier.

The CPI(M) and VCK claimed that they were not informed about the “new alliance”.

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The CPI(M) and VCK claimed that they were not informed about the “new alliance”.

Great Nicobar project not about defence but aimed at benefiting one businessman: Rahul

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Friday said the Modi government's argument that the Great Nicobar Island Project is about defence and a transshipment port is a “lie”, and alleged that it is actually about benefiting one businessman so that he can build hotels and casinos on India's most irreplaceable ecological land.

Gandhi released an over 16-minute video based on his visit to the Andaman and Nicobar Islands in late April and urged people to sign a petition to tell the Modi government - “we choose green over greed”.

“This World Environment Day, I want to ask every young Indian one question: What kind of India do you want to inherit? One where rainfor-



Congress MP Rahul Gandhi interacts with local residents during his visit to Campbell Bay village, in Andaman and Nicobar Islands

ests have been bulldozed for casinos, coral reefs erased from maps, tribal communities pushed off their land, and the air we breathe turned into poison? Or one where India's natural heritage is protected, our tribal communities are safe, and progress works with nature not against it,” Gandhi

said on X.

He alleged that right now, the Modi government is destroying Great Nicobar Island.

“More than 1.5 crore trees, ancient coral reefs, irreplaceable rainforests are being destroyed to profit one businessman,” the Leader of Oppo-

sition in the Lok Sabha claimed.

“This is your inheritance, they are bulldozing. And only you can stop them. Sign the petition. Tell the Modi government ‘we choose Green Over Greed’,” Gandhi said, sharing the link to the petition.

Meanwhile, the BJP on Friday hit back at Rahul Gandhi's criticism of the Great Nicobar development project, alleging that the Congress leader is “disturbed” by India's growing geopolitical expansion and would rather want to see other countries become more powerful than India.

BJP national spokesperson Tuhin Sinha said the vision for the Great Nicobar project dates back to the 1970s and accused the Congress of failing to implement such “futuristic” projects despite having conceived them decades ago.

WORLD ENVIRONMENT DAY Himachal government partners with UNDP for climate-resilient and sustainable development

ASHWANI SHARMA

SHIMLA: In a new landmark, the Himachal Pradesh government on Friday inked an MoU with the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) to advance climate-resilient, inclusive, and sustainable development in the state.

The partnership with an international funding agency is particularly significant for Himachal Pradesh, which has been increasingly vulnerable to climate change-induced disasters, prolonged dry spells, and extreme weather events.

These challenges have adversely impacted agriculture and horticulture while also accelerating the depletion of rivers, springs, and other natural water sources.

The agreement was signed in the presence of Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu, Secretary, Environment, Science, Technology and Climate Change, Sushil Singla, signed the MoU on behalf of the state government, while Angela Lusigi, resident representative, signed on behalf of UNDP.



Significantly, the MoU was signed on World Environment Day, during a state-level function organised at the Ridge of Shimla, where the Chief Minister also conferred awards on the winners of the mini-marathon and on those who had contributed to the protection of the environment, individually or through institutions, NGOs, and organisations.

APG Shimla University also contributed to the cash prizes awarded by the Chief Minister to the winners adjudged first, second and third in the half marathon—part of the Chief

Minister-led anti-drug mass awareness drive in the state.

The UNDP partnership envisages collaboration in key areas such as circular economy, waste management, social inclusion of waste management workers, electric mobility for waste collection, and other climate-resilient development priorities.

The MoU also covers natural resource management and biodiversity conservation, strengthening of regulatory and governance frameworks for ecological resilience in climate-vulnerable regions of the state.

Key Points

- » The partnership with an international funding agency is particularly significant for Himachal
- » Significantly, the MoU was signed on World Environment Day, during a state-level function organised at the Ridge of Shimla

spread awareness about the ill effects of drugs. Later, the chief minister arrived at the Ridge to confer awards and address the participants.

Speaking at the occasion, the chief minister said that the government has launched a mass movement against chitta. But this is not merely a government campaign but a people's movement involving youth, women, and communities across the state.

“Himachal is the first state in the country where drug traffickers and chitta peddlers have been identified down to the Panchayat level. Strict action is being taken in areas heavily affected by drug abuse, and the government's efforts have significantly weakened the drug network,” he said.

The Chief Minister issued a stern warning to those involved in drug trafficking and said that the state government would completely crush the chitta mafia. The government would ensure stricter action against those involved if they fail to reform.

Nation Briefs

TN ASSEMBLY SESSION TO BEGIN ON JUNE 18 WITH GUV ADDRESS: SPEAKER

CHENNAI: The Tamil Nadu Assembly session will commence on June 18 with the customary address of the Governor, Speaker J C D Prabhakar announced on Friday. Responding to media queries regarding the duration of the session and other details, the Speaker stated that everything will be officially announced after the conclusion of the Business Advisory Committee (BAC) meeting. “Whenever BAC meets, all information will be shared with you,” Prabhakar told reporters.

TELANGANA: FORMER YSRCP MLA ARRESTED IN LAND GRAB CASE

HYDERABAD: Former YSRCP MLA from Andhra Pradesh, Bolla Brahma Naidu, was arrested on Friday in a case of alleged attempt to grab about 10 acres of government land here, Telangana police said. Police said Brahma Naidu, who was on the run, was arrested at Kancheepuram in Tamil Nadu, and he would be produced before the court. The Cyberabad Police registered a case last month following a complaint made by the Tahsildar of Gandipet here on the matter. The complainant alleged that fake Government Orders (GOs), revenue records and other documents were created to illegally take possession of and regularise a 10-acres of land. During the investigation, police have already arrested several other accused in the case.

PROJECT IN FINAL STAGE

Smart borders to come up soon: HM Amit Shah

‘New security grid to feature cutting-edge tech’

MPOST BUREAU

AGARTALA: Union Home minister Amit Shah on Friday said the government’s “smart border” project is in the final stage, and the new security grid will feature cutting-edge tech, local administration and border sentinels.

Shah, addressing BSF personnel at Lankamura Border Outpost in Tripura, said wherever troops of the force is deployed, “we will build smart borders there”.

“Smart borders will be introduced soon with a new security grid to include cutting-edge tech, local administration and border sentinels,” the Home minister said.

“The concept of smart border will be implemented in seven to eight places of the country as a pilot project. I request the Union home secretary and the director general of the BSF to visit border areas, and hold talks,” Shah said.

Shah said every border has its own challenges, from human trafficking and arms smuggling to drug supply, “but the BSF jawans do their best to face these challenges”. “To make India a ‘viksit’ (developed) nation by 2047, we have to stop the entry of fake notes, human trafficking and drugs smuggling from across the borders,” the senior BJP leader said.

‘Won’t tolerate demographic changes in West Bengal, Tripura, Bihar

Shah also said that the government will not tolerate demographic changes in West Bengal, Tripura and Bihar, asserting that the Centre is taking steps to bridge gaps in guarding the coun-



Union Home minister Amit Shah interacts with BSF personnel during his visit to Lankamura Border Outpost in Tripura

INSIGHT

» Smart borders will be introduced soon with a new security grid to include cutting-edge tech, local administration and border sentinels, he said

» Shah said every border has its own challenges,

from human trafficking and arms smuggling to drug supply, ‘but the BSF jawans do their best to face these challenges’

» Shah also said that the government will not tolerate demographic changes in West Bengal, Tripura and Bihar

try’s borders.

“Demographic changes in West Bengal, Tripura and Bihar will not be tolerated... The Centre is making all efforts to bridge the gaps in guarding international borders,” he said.

Shah had in May said the government will launch a tech-enabled “smart border” project by the next year to make the 6,000-km fronts with Pakistan and Bangladesh impenetrable, and ensure that the “conspiracy” to change the demography of the country is defeated.

“The government of India has decided that not only will we stop infiltration, but we

will find each and every infiltrator and send them out of the country,” the home minister had said.

“I want to assure BSF troops that we will launch the smart border project within the 60th year of its raising, and we will make the Bangladesh and Pakistan borders impenetrable through major technical assistance,” Shah had said in New Delhi on May 22, while delivering the annual Rustamji Memorial lecture hosted by the BSF.

The “smart border” will use technology, drones, radars and smart cameras to help create an impenetrable border, he told the gathering.

Kerala High Court upholds ED’s power to initiate inquiries without prior FIR

Court clarifies powers under Sections 5 & 50 of PMLA are civil in nature

NARESH BISWANI

KOCHI: In a significant judgment reinforcing the powers of the Directorate of Enforcement (ED) under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), the Kerala High Court has ruled that the agency can initiate inquiries and undertake civil proceedings even in the absence of a prior FIR or complaint relating to a scheduled offence.

A Division Bench dismissed an appeal filed by Cochin Minerals and Rutile Limited (CMRL) and some of its employees challenging the validity of an Enforcement Case Information Report (ECIR) and summons issued by the ED’s Kochi Zonal Office.

The petitioners had argued that the ED could not pro-



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

ceed without a formal criminal complaint linked to a scheduled offence. However, the court held that an ECIR is not equivalent to an FIR and that its registration is not mandatory under the PMLA. The Bench observed that the law does not require the ED to furnish a copy of the ECIR to persons being investigated. Referring to the Supreme

KEY POINTS

- » A Division Bench dismissed an appeal filed by CMRL and some of its employees challenging the validity of an ECIR and summons issued by ED’s Kochi Zonal Office
- » The petitioners had argued that the ED could not proceed without a formal criminal complaint linked to a scheduled offence

Court’s judgment in the case of Vijay Madanlal Choudhary vs Union of India, the court clarified that powers under Sections 5 and 50 of the PMLA, including attachment of property and summoning individuals, are civil in nature and can be exercised independently of the registration of an FIR.

The Bench also ruled that

immunity granted by the Income Tax Settlement Commission does not bar proceedings under the PMLA, as protection under tax laws cannot be extended to money laundering investigations.

The judgment affirms the ED’s dual preventive and investigative role under the anti-money laundering framework.

RCF Kapurthala observes World Environment Day



KAPURTHALA: Rail Coach Factory (RCF), Kapurthala, marked World Environment Day 2026 with a series of awareness and conservation activities, reaffirming its commitment to environmental sustainability. Organised under the theme “Inspired by Nature, For Climate. For Our Future,” the programme began on May 15 and concluded on June 5 with several events aimed at promoting environmental consciousness.

On the final day, an awareness rally by the Bharat Scouts & Guides and the St.

John Ambulance Brigade was flagged off by RCF General Manager Ajay Nandan, who also joined participants and encouraged them to contribute towards environmental protection.

A tree plantation drive was also conducted across the RCF campus, with senior officers, employees and members of the Women Welfare Organisation, led by its President Navita Nandan, planting saplings to enhance green cover. The celebrations concluded with a valedictory function organised by the Quality Department. MPOST

Saini launches ₹2,738-cr project for sustainable horticulture promotion

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday said farmers, youth, women and modern technology would be the key drivers in achieving the vision of Viksit Bharat-2047. He asserted that making Haryana a leader in horticulture, agribusiness, food processing, cold chain infrastructure and agricultural exports remains a top priority of the state government.

Addressing a World Environment Day programme in Panchkula, Saini launched the Japan International Cooperation Agency (JICA)-funded Sustainable Horticulture Promotion Project worth Rs 2,738 crore and laid the foundation stone of the Haryana Agri-Business and Cold Chain Centre. He said the initiatives would help increase farmers’ incomes

while transforming Haryana’s agricultural ecosystem into a modern, sustainable and high-value sector.

The CM called for collective efforts to make agriculture more profitable and environmentally sustainable, promote water conservation and ensure a cleaner environment for future generations. Agriculture Minister Shyam Singh Rana was also present at the event. Earlier, the leaders planted saplings under the ‘Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam’ campaign and visited an exhibition organised by the Horticulture Department.

Expressing confidence that Haryana would lead a horticulture and agri-business revolution as it once led the Green Revolution, Saini said changing climatic conditions, declining groundwater levels, rising

cultivation costs and shrinking landholdings make agricultural diversification essential.

Highlighting the horticulture project, he noted that nearly 20-30 per cent of fruits and vegetables perish before reaching markets. To address this, the project will develop 400 horticulture clusters, strengthen 500 producer groups and create post-harvest infrastructure, including pack houses, fulfilment centres and retail outlets. It also envisages the construction of 1,000 rainwater harvesting structures and expansion of micro-irrigation to 65,000 acres.

Saini also announced plantation activities on 1,000 hectares of waterlogged land using biodegradation technology and the construction or renovation of 50 dams in the Shivalik and Aravalli regions. MPOST

Imphal: CISF foils major ‘narcotics’ smuggling bid

OUR CORRESPONDENT

IMPHAL: The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) foiled a major narcotics smuggling attempt at Imphal International Airport, seizing more than 4 kg of suspected heroin from the luggage of two passengers travelling to Kolkata, officials said on Friday.

The seizure was made during routine security screening at around 11 am when CISF personnel noticed suspicious behaviour by a passenger carrying two large bags. According to officials, the man appeared anxious and repeatedly attempted to avoid baggage inspection, claiming he was running late for his flight. His conduct prompted security personnel to subject the luggage to a more detailed examination.

During screening through the X-BIS scanner at the airport’s departure entrance, CISF staff detected suspicious objects concealed inside specially designed false compartments in the bags. A thorough search led to the recovery of two packets containing a substance suspected to be heroin.

Officials said one bag contained approximately 2.05 kg of the suspected narcotic, while the second held about 2.04 kg, taking the total seizure to nearly 4.09 kg.

During preliminary questioning, the passenger informed CISF personnel that one of the bags belonged to another individual who had already entered the airport’s secure zone. Acting swiftly, the CISF Crime Intelligence Wing traced the second passenger inside the terminal, where he reportedly claimed ownership of the luggage.

Both individuals, along with the seized contraband and relevant documents, were handed over to Singamei Police Station for further investigation and legal action. Authorities are continuing their probe to determine the source and intended destination of the suspected narcotics.

CBSE extends Class 12 verification, re-evaluation application deadline

NEW DELHI: The CBSE on Friday extended the last date for submission of applications for verification and re-evaluation of Class 12 answer sheets by one day till June 7.

The move comes after several students flagged issues in accessing answer books and applying for verification and re-evaluation on the CBSE’s post-result services portal launched on June 2.

“In the interest of students, the CBSE has decided to extend the last date for submission of applications for verification and re-evaluation for the Class 12 board examinations, thereby providing students additional time and support to complete the process,” the board said in a post on X. The previous deadline of June 6 (midnight) has now



been extended to June 7 (midnight), it said.

“Students are requested to take note of the revised schedule and submit their applications accordingly,” it added.

The CBSE on Tuesday opened the online portal for verification of issues observed in scanned copies of answer books and re-evaluation of answers for students dissatisfied with their board exam evaluation.

The board had said that for

verification of issues in scanned copies of answer books, students can report concerns such as missing pages, missing supplementary sheets, missing maps or graphs, blurred pages, incorrect answer books or evaluation against a different question paper set.

The CBSE has been embroiled in controversy after some Class 12 students claimed that the scanned copies of their answer sheets, uploaded by the board, did not match their handwriting, raising concerns about potential mismatches in the on-screen marking (OSM) system.

The Cabinet Secretariat has announced the formation of a one-member committee to investigate the procurement of services for the OSM system by the CBSE. MPOST

Madhya Pradesh’s e-Nagar Palika wins national e-Governance Award

State’s digital civic ecosystem leverages Zero Trust Architecture and AI-driven services for transparent urban governance

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: Madhya Pradesh’s flagship e-Nagar Palika platform has been conferred the prestigious National e-Governance Award, marking a significant recognition of the state’s efforts to strengthen digital governance, cybersecurity and citizen-centric urban services.

Chief Minister Mohan Yadav hailed the achievement as a matter of pride for the state, saying Madhya Pradesh had secured this honour at the National e-Governance Awards 2026. In a post on X, he noted that the Urban Administration and Development Department’s ‘Cyber Security Framework in e-Nagar Palika’ had received the Award. Describing the accolades as a testament to the state’s commitment to e-governance, innovation and technology-driven public service delivery.

Urban Administration and Development Commissioner Sanket Bhondve said the award reflects national-level apprecia-



Sanket Bhondve

HIGHLIGHTS

- » 24 citizen services on a single platform
- » GIS-based property management system
- » Continuous monitoring of citizen data security
- » Improved efficiency of urban local bodies

tion for the state’s innovations in e-governance, secure digital infrastructure and transparent public service delivery under the leadership of the Chief Minister.

Bhondve said the e-Nagar Palika system has been designed not only to simplify and expedite civic services but also to ensure the highest standards of data security and privacy. The platform is built on a modern cloud infrastructure and incorporates advanced cybersecurity features, including a Zero Trust Architecture (ZTA), data encryption and continuous

cyber monitoring.

According to the commissioner, the integrated digital ecosystem safeguards the confidentiality, integrity and availability of citizens’ data while adhering to established security and compliance standards.

He said the initiative aligns with the Prime Minister’s Digital India vision, with the state government focusing on delivering accessible and transparent online services without compromising cybersecurity and data protection.

Under the recently expanded e-Nagar Palika 2.0 framework, the platform now offers GIS-based property management, cloud-enabled data administration, Artificial Intelligence-driven services and integration with various government digital platforms, including UMANG. The system currently supports more than 20 administrative modules and provides 24 citizen services through a unified interface.

Describing the award as a milestone for the state, Bhondve said it reinforces Madhya Pradesh’s commitment to digital innovation, secure governance and citizen-focused public administration and would further strengthen its vision of building a technologically advanced and digitally empowered state.

Officials said the integrated platform has improved the operational efficiency of urban local bodies while enabling faster, more transparent and hassle-free service delivery for citizens.



FILE PIC

security pensions would also be eligible for benefits under the scheme. He added that nearly 97 per cent of women in Punjab are expected to benefit, and the state government has earmarked Rs 9,300 crore in the budget for its implementation.

Emphasising the social significance of the initiative, Mann said the assistance would enhance women’s financial autonomy and strengthen their role in household and community decision-making. “Women

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann on Friday announced that financial assistance under the Mukh Mantri Mawan Dheeyan Satkar Yojna will begin reaching eligible women beneficiaries across the state from July 1.

Reviewing the implementation of the flagship scheme, Mann said it aims to strengthen women’s financial independence and ensure they live with dignity and self-respect. Under the scheme, every eligible woman will receive Rs 1,000 per month, while women belonging to the Scheduled Caste category will be provided Rs 1,500 per month. The amount will be transferred directly into beneficiaries’ bank accounts.

The Chief Minister said women already receiving social

Puninderdeep Brar assumes charge as PSPCL Director



PATIALA: Puninderdeep Singh Brar on Friday assumed charge as Director/Generation of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited (PSPCL) following his appointment to the key post by the corporation.

Prior to his elevation, Brar was serving as Engineer in Chief (P&M) in Ludhiana and was the senior-most among the serving chief engineers in PSPCL.

With over 34 years of experience in the power sector, he brings extensive technical and administrative expertise to the position.

Brar expressed gratitude to Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann, Power minister Tarunpreet Singh Sond, and Secretary Power-cum-Chairman and Managing Director of PSPCL Basant Garg for entrusting him with the responsibility. MPOST

NHRC issues notices after 3 die cleaning Ludhiana sewer

NEW DELHI: Taking suo motu cognisance of the deaths of three workers who allegedly inhaled toxic fumes while cleaning a sewage line inside a factory in Ludhiana on June 1, the NHRC has issued notices to the Punjab Chief Secretary and Ludhiana Police Commissioner, seeking a detailed report into the incident.

According to reports, the workers were hired to clean a sewage system used for disposing of chemical waste and entered the sewer without safety equipment. Observing that the incident, if true, raises serious human rights concerns, the NHRC has sought a detailed report from the officials within two weeks on the investigation, condition of the injured and compensation provided. MPOST

Nation Briefs

ECR MARKS WORLD ENVIRONMENT DAY WITH MASSIVE PLANTATION DRIVE

HAJIPUR: Marking World Environment Day, East Central Railway intensified its environmental conservation efforts with large-scale tree plantation drives and awareness campaigns across its five divisions. General Manager Chhatrasal Singh planted saplings at Madhu Vihar Colony in Danapur and the under-construction Pataliputra Coaching Complex, alongside senior railway officials. Members of the ECR Women’s Welfare Organisation also participated in the plantation drive, promoting the message of environmental protection. As part of a campaign held from May 15 to June 5, special focus was given to the “Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam” initiative.

NFR OBSERVES WORLD ENVIRONMENT DAY 2026 WITH EXTENSIVE GREEN INITIATIVES

MALIGAON: The Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR) observed World Environment Day through a series of environmental awareness and sustainability initiatives conducted across all its divisions and units from May 15 to June 5 under the theme “Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future.” Throughout the campaign period, railway employees, passengers, students, Scouts & Guides, social organizations and members of the public participated enthusiastically in various activities promoting environmental conservation and sustainable development. The observance culminated on Friday, with officials participating in the programme organised by Railway Board.

PUTIN REJECTS ZELENSKY'S OFFER TO MEET

Russia ready for peace under Trump's proposal if Kyiv compromises: Putin

ST PETERSBURG: Russia is "ready and willing" to reach an agreement with Ukraine based on US President Donald Trump's peace proposal if Kyiv was ready to make certain "compromises", President Vladimir Putin has said even as he asserted that Russian forces are dominating the battlefield.

In an interaction with heads of leading global news agencies, including PTI on Thursday night, the Russian President said Moscow is strengthening its air defences to counter Ukrainian drone strikes, asserting that the "patriotism and will of the Russian people" will ensure they achieve their goals in Ukraine.

In a related development, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, in an open letter to Putin, called for a face-to-face meeting between himself and the Russian President to end the war peacefully.

However, Putin rejected



Russian President Vladimir Putin

Ukrainian President's proposal to have a meeting.

"Is it a way to create conditions for personal meetings and talks, or create an environment which makes any personal meetings impossible?" he said. "I think it's the second."

He said that he sees "no point" in the meeting.

Zelenskyy had pitched for

a full ceasefire to hold negotiations between the two sides. The Kremlin said it received the letter.

In the press interaction where PTI was the only Indian media outlet, Putin insisted that Ukraine will have to make compromises and specifically referred to the summit meeting he had with President

Highlights

» Zelenskyy called for a face-to-face meeting between himself and the Russian President to end the war peacefully

» Putin said Russian military has brought approximately 2,440 square kilometres of territory under its control recently

Trump in Alaska's Anchorage in August last year.

"Without doubt, we are ready and willing to reach an agreement with Ukraine by peaceful means -- and based on what we have discussed at the meeting with President Trump in Anchorage," Putin said.

"At that meeting, certain questions were put before Russia so that we could agree on

certain compromises. Russia agrees to the compromises discussed in Anchorage. It is necessary that Ukraine also agrees to make them. Then, the conflict will be resolved naturally and quickly," he said without elaborating.

Putin said Russian military has brought approximately 2,440 square kilometres of territory under its control recently by pushing Ukrainian forces and that there is not a single place in the battlefield where Russian troops are not advancing.

"The offensive is ongoing on a daily basis. At present, the Russian Federation has taken full control of the Luhansk People's Republic. Russia has brought over 85 per cent of the territory of the Donetsk People's Republic under its control. We also control 80 per cent of the Zaporozhye Region. This process continues on a daily basis," he said. AGENCIES

It's been unable to inspect Iranian facilities: IAEA

VIENNA: The UN nuclear watchdog has been unable to inspect nuclear facilities in Iran affected by the war last June according to a confidential report by the UN nuclear watchdog circulated to member states. The International Atomic Energy Agency reported that it "cannot provide any information on the current size, composition or whereabouts of the stockpile of enriched uranium in Iran or whether Iran has suspended all enrichment-related activities."

The IAEA warned that it was "unable to discharge its safeguards responsibilities" that it has under the Safeguards Agreement of the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty, adding that it is "indispensable and urgent" for Tehran to implement its obligations under that Treaty. The only nuclear facility inspected in Iran by IAEA inspectors since the last report in February has been the Bushehr nuclear power plant, which was visited on June 1-3. The reactor currently running at Bushehr uses uranium from Russia enriched to 4.5 per cent,



IAEA chief Rafael Mariano Grossi

The confidential report come as tensions have flared in the Middle East

a low level needed for power generation in such plants.

The confidential report come as tensions have flared in the Middle East. Iranian drones heavily damaged a passenger terminal at Kuwait's main airport on Wednesday, killing one person, wounding

dozens of others and briefly closing the airfield -- the latest in back-and-forth attacks by Iran and the US that test a fragile ceasefire.

According to the IAEA, Iran maintains a stockpile of 440.9 kg of uranium enriched up to 60 per cent purity -- a short, technical step away from weapons-grade levels of 90 per cent. That stockpile could allow Iran to build as many as 10 nuclear bombs, should it decide to weaponise its programme, IAEA director general Rafael Grossi warned in a recent AP interview. AGENCIES

'Trump's back-and-forth on troops in Europe potentially cost millions'

WASHINGTON: The US military is still waiting for clarity from the Pentagon following President Donald Trump's back-and-forth on troop levels in Europe, upending the lives of military personnel and potentially costing taxpayers millions of dollars, two US defense officials told The Associated Press.

NATO allies were bewildered in May when Trump said he would send 5,000 U.S. troops to Poland just weeks after ordering the same number pulled from Europe, following a spat with Germany's Chancellor Friedrich Merz over the Iran war. The Trump administration says troop reductions in Europe have long been planned and coordinated with allies.

The Republican president announced on social media two weeks ago that he was sending troops to Poland -- the same day the Pentagon had officially ordered the cancellation of a rotation of soldiers heading there, one of the

“THE ABRUPT CHANGES ARE FORCING THE MILITARY TO RETROACTIVELY ENGINEER A POLICY IN LINE”

defense officials said.

The unit's equipment was already on the way. Sending it cost the military \$32 million, said U.S. Transportation Command, the military agency largely responsible for moving troops and gear across the globe.

The abrupt changes are forcing the military to "retroactively engineer" a policy in line with the president's latest pronouncement, the official said. Both officials were briefed on the decisions and, along with others, spoke on condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive

military matters.

The uncertainty is not only rattling European allies worried about the message being sent to Russia, but it also risks hurting morale among American troops -- some of whom had their rotations canceled shortly before departure -- and comes as the Army budget is already strained.

The rotational deployment to Poland of 4,000 troops from the Army's 2nd Armored Brigade Combat Team, 1st Cavalry Division, based in Fort Hood, Texas, was canceled in a memo sent to the military at the beginning of May. European allies found out mid-month.

Some of those troops were told shortly before traveling not to get on a flight to Poland, while those who had been sent ahead -- initially around 1,000 troops -- are still waiting for confirmation they are being sent back, a U.S. military official said. AGENCIES

DIBBINE: Israel's air force struck different parts of southern Lebanon on Friday as the military issued evacuation warnings for nine villages, including one that has been spared much of the destruction and was sheltering thousands of people displaced by the three-month war.

Six people were killed, Lebanon's state news agency reported.

The warnings forced hundreds of families to flee the village of Anqoun and the area of Aarnaya, on the edge of the predominantly Christian village of Maghdoucheh, near the southern port of Sidon.

The strikes came a day after the Hezbollah militant group rejected the latest ceasefire agreement between Israel and the Lebanese government, and demanded a complete Israeli withdrawal from Lebanon.

Lebanon's Parliament Speaker Nabih Berri, a strong



Lebanese army soldier removes the rubble of a house that was destroyed in the recent clashes between Hezbollah fighters in Dibbine village on Friday AP/PTI

ally of Hezbollah who has been acting as a mediator on behalf of the group, said in his first comment on the agreement reached in Washington this week that he accepts Hezbollah's withdrawal from the areas south of the Litani River as long as it coincides with the

withdrawal of Israeli troops from southern Lebanon.

The river, located about 30 kilometres north of the border with Israel, forms the boundary of a 2006 UN-established buffer zone in which Hezbollah is banned.

Israeli troops have currently pushed far past the Litani River into southern Lebanon. AGENCIES

AMID SPLITS OVER TRUMP FUND- Senate passes \$70bn for immigration crackdown



WASHINGTON: The Senate passed legislation to fund President Donald Trump's immigration enforcement agencies early Friday morning, after weeks of delays and fierce backlash to an unrelated \$1.776 billion settlement fund that threatened to derail the bill.

Senators voted 52-47 for the \$70 billion legislation to fund Immigration and Customs Enforcement and Border Patrol for the next three years, through the end of Trump's term.

The final vote came just before 5 am, after Republicans narrowly defeated multiple attempts by Democrats and Republicans to add language to the bill that would permanently ban Trump's settlement fund for political allies who believe they have been politically persecuted.

Republicans cleared a major hurdle overnight when they defeated an amendment proposed by one of their own members, Louisiana Sen. Bill Cassidy, that would have redirected payments from the settlement to members of law enforcement who were injured in the January 6, 2021 attack on the Capitol.

The amendments were a test of party unity that complicated what should have been

Key Points

» Republicans cleared a major hurdle overnight when they defeated an amendment proposed by one of their own members

» The amendments were a test of party unity that complicated what should have been an easy vote for Republicans

THE FINAL VOTE CAME JUST BEFORE 5 AM

an easy vote for Republicans who wanted to keep the focus on immigration enforcement in an election year.

Instead, they spent almost a full day haggling among themselves over whether to block the settlement fund, even after acting Attorney General Todd Blanche had said earlier this week that it would not go forward.

"This would have been done several hours ago if we weren't having to deal with some of the issues around the fund," Senate Majority Leader John Thune, R-SD, said shortly before midnight. AGENCIES

There're no visa laws that target India specifically: US official on H1B

NEW YORK: Amid immigration concerns among Indians in the US on visas such as H1B, a senior American official has said that the country's visa laws are not targeting India specifically but are being consistently applied globally across the board.

"When it comes to visas... what we had here for a long time with previous administrations going back was inconsistent application of visa law. That is no longer the case. We are consistently applying visa law across the board. I think

that will offer clarity," State Department Spokesperson Tommy Pigott said.

Pigott was responding to a question by PTI on immigration, including concerns among Indians in the US on H1B visas, during a roundtable meeting organised by the New York Foreign Press Centre with a select group of journalists here on Thursday.

"There are no visa laws that target India. These are global visa laws that are being implemented with clarity, clear instructions that are being

There is also concern over increasing instances of hateful rhetoric targeted against immigrants, including Indians, due to administration's immigration policies

applied across the board," he said.

He added that when it comes to visa policy in general, "we are of course going to work with other countries to allow people to enter the country that are needed for trade and investment, to work, and

there are numerous examples of that happening with different bilateral partners across the world." "We also are clear, as in any country, that if you are going to create a job in the US, that we want to make sure that Americans have opportunities there, and every country has

As Ebola spreads in Congo, radio station tries to stop health misinformation

The 45-minute program runs daily at 10 am, reminding people of dangers of Ebola & regularly featuring health specialists who provide updates

BUNIA: The rare Bundibugyo type of Ebola that Congo is battling took locals by surprise after weeks of spreading unnoticed. Hundreds of cases were suspected when Congolese authorities announced the outbreak on May 15, but many dismissed the news as a "Western conspiracy."

At least 63 people have died from 397 confirmed cases, the Africa Centres for Disease Control and Prevention said Friday. Yet the outbreak has been challenged by scepticism, attacks on health workers and misinformation.

Vérité Johnson, a journalist and editorial secretary at the Radio Télévision Mont Bleu station in Bunia, the capital city of the eastern Ituri province where the outbreak is concentrated, decided to produce a new program to combat rumors.

The radio show has emerged as a vital tool to win over some residents who have been unaware or sceptical about the facts of Bundibugyo.



A health worker collects meals for Ebola patients at the treatment center in Rwampara on Friday AP/PTI

The 45-minute program runs daily at 10 am, reminding people of the dangers of Ebola and regularly featuring health specialists who provide updates and answer questions. The show's jingles about the virus play intermittently throughout the day and residents are able to call in with questions. "So far, there's still a layer of resistance within the population, and that's where

the media plays an important role," Johnson said.

"Misinformation is almost as dangerous as the virus itself and spreads just as fast. Earning and keeping the trust of communities is at the heart of everything we do," World Health Organisation Director-General Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus said Friday as WHO and the Africa CDC launched an Ebola response

plan with partners.

Tedros said the new plan aims to raise \$518 million to "stop the outbreak where it is, support countries that are responding today and ensure that neighbouring countries are ready to detect and act quickly if cases appear."

Resistance to protocols during public health emergencies is common in Congo, which is battling its 17th Ebola outbreak since the virus was first identified there in 1976. There currently is no approved vaccine or treatment for the Bundibugyo type of Ebola, which has added another layer of fear.

Widespread rumors, often arising from fear and misinformation, discourage residents from adhering to health warnings or seeking medical help during an outbreak, health officials say.

Many residents remain distrustful of health authorities, with some alleging that officials are profiting from the outbreak. AGENCIES

World Briefs

MARITIME DRONE EXPLODES AT ROMANIAN BLACK SEA PORT

BUCHAREST: A maritime drone that is being used in the war in neighbouring Ukraine exploded Friday at a Black Sea port in Romania but did not cause any casualties, the Defence Ministry said. It said the drone self-detonated in the port of Constanta at around 10:30 am, and that the area had already been secured and isolated by the Romanian Intelligence Service, coast guard and the Defence Ministry. The drone was not part of the Romanian army's equipment and was not involved in its recent exercises in the Black Sea area, the ministry said. The area was evacuated, authorities said.

NASA ORDERS ASTRONAUTS TO TAKE SHELTER AFTER NEW LEAK ABOARD ISS

WASHINGTON: NASA on Friday ordered astronauts to take shelter after a fresh leak was detected aboard the International Space Station. The five astronauts moved into the SpaceX capsule that is docked at the station while cosmonauts worked to fix the leak, which is on the Russian side of the orbiting laboratory. The decision was made "out of an abundance of caution," NASA spokesperson Bethany Stevens said via X. That part of the space station has suffered from cracks and leaks over the years. NASA said Roscosmos decided to do a more extensive repair after fresh leaks were found. The space agencies have been working to determine the cause of the cracks.

EXPERTS SAY KIM WANTS GLOBAL RECOGNITION AS A NUCLEAR STATE

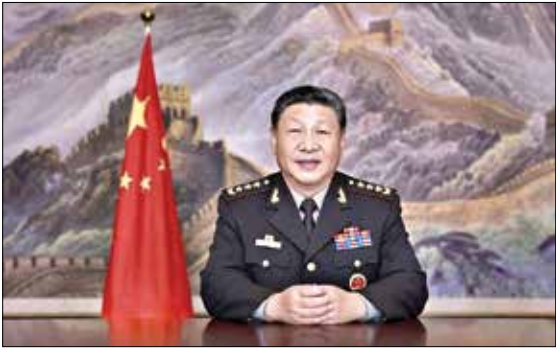
Xi will travel to North Korea next week in first visit since 2019

BEIJING: Chinese leader Xi Jinping will travel to North Korea next week, both countries announced Friday, in what will be his first visit in nearly seven years.

His trip will be the latest in a series of steps by China to reinforce its close ties with its nuclear-armed neighbour, whose leader Kim Jong Un has reached out to Russia in recent years, notably by sending troops and conventional weapons to support its war against Ukraine.

Kim has likewise been cozying up again to China, the North's biggest trade partner and aid provider, in the past year.

"As North Korea builds closer ties with Russia, China seeks to use Xi's trip to reassert its influence over Pyongyang and safeguard its strategic interests in northeast Asia,"



Chinese leader Xi Jinping

said William Yang, an analyst for the International Crisis Group.

Xi will make a state visit from Monday to Tuesday, state media from both nations said in brief dispatches. His last visit was in June 2019.

The trip will come just weeks after Xi hosted US President Donald Trump and Russian President Vladimir Putin

in quick succession in Beijing. North Korea's nuclear weapons programme has long been a major concern for the United States, which opposes it. The UN has imposed economic sanctions on North Korea because of its nuclear and missile development.

The announcement of the trip came a day after North Korea unveiled a new facility to produce the ingredients for nuclear bombs. South Korea's military has assessed the new nuclear facility as a uranium enrichment plant.

During a visit to the plant, Kim announced plans to bolster the country's nuclear forces "at an exponential rate".

Highlights

- » North Korean leader Kim has likewise been cozying up again to China
- » Kim has been focusing on expanding his nuclear arsenal since his high-stakes diplomacy with Trump collapsed in 2019
- » Trump has repeatedly expressed his desire to restore diplomacy with Kim Jong Un

Experts say the plant's disclosure implies that Kim was eager to cement his country's status as a nuclear weapons state ahead of Xi's visit.

The experts say Kim wants international recognition as a nuclear state so that he can demand the lifting of the sanctions. They say Kim would ultimately push for arms reductions talks with the US to win concessions in return for a partial surrender of his nuclear capability.

Kim has been focusing on expanding his nuclear arsenal since his high-stakes diplomacy with Trump collapsed in 2019. Trump has repeatedly expressed his desire to restore diplomacy with Kim, but the North Korean leader has said the US must first drop its demand for North Korea to denuclearize as a precondition for talks.

AGENCIES

Dreams, courage do not have a gender: Major Abhilasha Barak

UNITED NATIONS: Dreams, courage and the will to serve humanity do not have a gender, Indian woman peacekeeper Major Abhilasha Barak said on Friday, drawing upon her personal experience to underscore that opportunity enables women to break barriers and reach milestones.

Major Barak made the remarks after receiving the prestigious 2025 UN Military Gender Advocate Award from UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres at a ceremony held here to commemorate International Day of UN Peacekeepers.

She is serving with the Indian Battalion as the Commander of the Female Engagement Team (FET) in the UN Interim Force in Lebanon (UNIFIL). She is also the first woman combat helicopter pilot of the Indian Army.

"With gratitude and humility, I accept the 2025 United Nations Military Gender Advocate Award on behalf of my UNIFIL colleagues and my country, India," Barak said in her remarks at the ceremony. She added that it has been an honour for her to lead India's first Engagement Team in UNIFIL and to serve as the Military Gender Focal Point for INDBATT 26, advancing the Women, Peace and Security agenda and integrating gender perspectives into peacekeeping operations.

She said the award is a reminder that lasting peace can only be built when every voice is heard and every individual is empowered. "Because dreams do not have a gender



Indian woman peacekeeper Major Abhilasha Barak

— and neither does leadership, courage or the will to serve humanity."

She said that working in a complex operational environment taught her that real progress begins when every voice is heard, especially those of women that too often go unheard.

Barak underlined that her commitment to empowerment is also personal, noting that as the first woman combat helicopter pilot in the Indian Army, she "experienced firsthand how opportunity enables women to break barriers and reach milestones."

Barak is the third recipient of the UN Military Gender Advocate award from India, after Major Suman Gawani and Major Radhika Sen were honoured for their commendable work while serving in UN Peacekeeping missions in 2019 and 2023, respectively.

Highlighting her contingent's work at UNIFIL, Barak said they carried out outreach initiatives focused on gender empowerment.

Putin slams sanctions as damaging to global economy

ST. PETERSBURG: Russian President Vladimir Putin said Friday that developing countries have gained an increasingly important role in the global economy, while the share of output by Western countries has shrunk.

In a speech to the annual St. Petersburg International Economic Forum, Putin accused the West of undermining the global economy and finances with unilateral sanctions.

By freezing Russian assets abroad, Western nations eroded trust in their own currencies, he said.

"The sanctions and blocking of Russia's sovereign

reserves have irreversibly impacted the standing of international currencies, the dollar and the euro," he said.

"Just like Russia, any other country could lose access to their legitimate assets in dollars or euros, as well as Western financial and payment systems."

AGENCIES

millenniumpost
CLASSIFIEDS
CHANGE OF NAME
I, TANVEER AHMED S/O, MANSOOR AHMED R/O, 1951, MOHALLA QABRISTAN, HOUZ WALI MASJID, TURKMAN GATE DELHI-110006.HAVE CHANGE MY NAME FROM TANVEER TO TANVEER AHMED FOR ALL PURPOSES, LEGAL AND OTHER WISE.

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
Tender Notice No.: e-Tender/2026/19, Date: 04.06.2026. For and on behalf of President of India, the Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.), South Eastern Railway, Kharagpur-721301 invites e-tender for the following works before 15.00 hrs, on the date mentioned against items and will be opened at 15.30 hrs. Sl.No.-1. Tender No.: E-KGP-South-18-2026. Description of work: Civil Engineering works in connection with replacement of old & overage power supply lines and other assets to improve reliability of power supply system in wayside section under Sr.DEE/G/Kharagpur as phased under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN (South)/Kharagpur. Tender Value: ₹ 66,72,652.56. Earnest Money: ₹ 1,33,500. Sl.No.-2. Tender No.: E-KGP-EAST-29-2026. Description of work: Howrah-Kharagpur-TSR(P)-27.752 Tkm under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/ East/Kharagpur. Tender Value: ₹ 5,24,03,442.16. Earnest Money: ₹ 10,48,100. Sl.No.-3. Tender No.: E-KGP-EAST-32-2026. Description of work: Widening of Road & Height gauge at Panskura for Double Boom Level crossing at LC No 47 under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/East/Kharagpur. Tender Value: ₹ 42,20,451. Earnest Money: ₹ 84,409.02. Sl.No.-4. Tender No.: E-KGP-HQ-23-2026. Description of work: Improvement of infrastructure at LC gates by providing RDSO type Height gauges 56 sets for 56 nos. Level X-ings in Panskura-Haldia and Tamkul-Digha section under the jurisdiction of ADEN/Tamluk. Tender Value: ₹ 9,28,18,058.48. Earnest Money: ₹ 18,56,400. Sl.No.-5. Tender No.: E-KGP-EAST-33-2026. Description of work: Transportation of P/Way work materials from any station in Indian railway to work site (Kharagpur to Santargachhi) Store Depot of Kharagpur under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/East/Kharagpur. Tender Value: ₹ 1,37,90,544.66. Earnest Money: ₹ 2,75,800. Tender Document Cost: ₹ 0 (for Sl.No. 1 to 5 each). Date of Opening: 25.06.2026 (for Sl.No. 1) & 02.07.2026 (for Sl.No. 2 to 5 each). Completion Period of the work: 12 months (for Sl.No. 1 to 5 each). Bidding start date: From 11.06.2026 and up to 15.00 hrs, on 25.06.2026 (for Sl.No. 1) & from 18.06.2026 and up to 15.00 hrs, on 02.07.2026 (for Sl.No. 2 to 5). Interested tenderers may visit website www.ireps.gov.in for full details/ descriptions/specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tender for these works will be accepted. N.B.: Prospective bidders may regularly visit www.ireps.gov.in to participate in all tenders. (PR-283)

म.प्र. पुलिस आवास एवं अधोसंरचना विकास निगम
कार्यालय परियोजना यंत्री, इंदौर संभाग क्रमांक-02, इंदौर जी-13, प्रथम 'तल' एम.आई.जी. कॉलोनी, एम.आई.जी. थाने के पीछे, इंदौर (म.प्र.), मो. नं. : 9425601512
Email-Id : mpphidclindore2@gmail.com
निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना - 6/2026-27
म.प्र.पु.आ. एवं अधो.वि.नि., इंदौर संभाग क्र.-02, इंदौर द्वारा क्रमशः शासकीय उच्चतर माध्यमिक विद्यालय भवन निर्माण कार्य आशापुर (जिला खंडवा), बादरकच्छ एवं मालवन (जिला बड़वानी) हेतु निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 25.6.2026 तक खरीदे जा सकते हैं, जिसकी विस्तृत निविदा सूचना एवं अन्य विवरण <https://mptenders.gov.in> पर देखे जा सकते हैं।
म.प्र. माध्यम/126231/2026 परियोजना यंत्री

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement System
Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-
S. Tender No. Brief Description Qty. Closing Date
01 77265185 NUT & BOLT CMS CROSSING 3400 SET 25.06.2026
02 09262536 SPRING PLANK FOR CASNUB 22 HS BOGIE 1137 NOS 29.06.2026
03 77265186 NUT & BOLT CMS CROSSING 2400 SET 29.06.2026
04 19261981 SET OF COMMUTATOR SWITCH ASSEMBLY COMPLETE 9 NOS 06.07.2026
05 07250149B SECONDARY VERTICAL DAMPER FOR LHB NAC 2739 NOS 13.07.2026
06 07260203 FLEXBALL CABLE - LONG WITH END CONNECTION 202 NOS 23.07.2026
Note:- 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No manual offer will be entertained.
Tender Notice No.: 17/2026-2027 Dated: 05.06.2026 1927/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

OFFICE OF THE DY. COMMISSIONER OF POLICE, SOUTH-WEST DISTRICT
NELSON MANDELA MARG, VASANT VIHAR, NEW DELHI-110057. TELEPHONE NO.011-26140002-03, FAX NO. 011-26140024. E-MAIL:- dcp-southwest-dl@nic.in

ORDER
A committee comprising of the following officers are hereby constituted for auction of vehicle No. DL-8C-AF-5093 (Hyundai New Varna CRDI SX 1.6 Silver Colour) in compliance of the order dated 07.04.26 passed by the Hon'ble Court of MACT, Patiala House Court New Delhi, in case FIR No. 381/2020 U/S 279/304A/IPC, & 146/196 MV Act, PS Delhi Cantt. South West District:-
1. ACP/DELHI CANTT.
2. SHO/DELHI CANTT.
3. INSPR.MACT/SWD
4. I/C MT/SWD
Auction Date: 12.06.2026 (At Delhi Cantt Police Station)
Anybody interested may attend the Auction.
They shall carry out all the formalities required for auction of vehicle No. DL-8C-AF-5093 (Hyundai New Varna CRDI SX 1.6 Silver Colour) and file the report before the Hon'ble Court. (VIKAS MEENA) IPS
ADDL. DY. COMMISSIONER OF POLICE, SOUTH-WEST DISTRICT, NEW DELHI
DP/7459/SW/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN-E-TENDER NOTICE
The Sr. Divisional Engineer-II, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.
1 NIT-17 Name of work:- Provision of safety fencing (Anti-Crash Barrier fencing) of 61.1114 Kms on GZB-SRE section in the section of ADEN-MUT under SR.DEN-II. Approx cost of work:- 351358102.10 Earnest Money to be deposited:- 7027200.00
2 NIT-18 Name of work:- Cess repair work at various locations under ADEN/GZB in jurisdiction of Sr. DEN-II/DLI. Approx cost of work:- 2431156.11 Earnest Money to be deposited:- 486200.00
3 Date & time of opening of tender 03.07.2026 15:00 Hrs.
4 Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen www.ireps.gov.in
The tenderers must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in the e-tender system. For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. No manual offers are acceptable. Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only. No. 128-W/280/E Tender Notice/NIT-17 & 18-26-27-W-II Dated :- 05.06.2026 1931/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT, CIRCLE NO-1 RAIPUR (C.G.)
Tender Notice
Contractors, Registered appropriate class in Unified Registration System (e-Registration) invited Online tenders for the following works :-
NIT No./ System Tender No. Name of Work Probable amount of contract
1 2 3
50/191384 S/R, Mow & Deposit Work at Mekahara Section & Consumer Forum Under Construction Sub Division No-2, Raipur (C.G.) (1st Call) Rs. 50.00 Lakh
70/191850 Ordinary Maintenance Work For Building at Mekahara Section & Nursing College Section Under Const. Sub Division No-2, Raipur (1st Call) Rs. 50.00 Lakh
71/191851 Ordinary Maintenance Work For Building At Medical College Section Under Construction Sub Division No-2, Raipur (C.G.) (1st Call) Rs. 50.00 Lakh
10/192339 Construction Of (Balance Work) 4 Way Direction CC Road, BT Road & Drain Work (Length - 2.373km) At Pt. Jawahar Lal Nehru, Ward No. 2, Kabeer Nagar, Municipal Corporation, Raipur I/C Culverts At Dist. Raipur (2nd Call) Rs. 124.59 Lakh
01/192373 Construction of Internal Road of Mahant Laxmi Narayan Das Ward Dist. Raipur (C.G.) (2nd Call) Rs. 194.34 Lakh
NIT No.50 System Tender No.191384, NIT No.70 System Tender No.191850, NIT No.71 System Tender No.191851 Last date of tender Download Date up to 23.06.2026 Time 17:30 PM & NIT No.10 System Tender No.192339 & NIT No.01 System Tender No.192373 Last date of tender Download Date up to 18.06.2026 Time 17:30 PM
Note :- All eligible/interested contractors are mandated to get enrolled on the e Procurement portal (<https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in>), in order to download the tender documents and participate in the subsequent bidding process.
G 262701233/ 5
Superintending Engineer
P.W.D. Raipur Circle No-1, Raipur (C.G.)

New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Administrative Building, Sector-6, Noida 201301 (U.P.)
Website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in
E-TENDER NOTICE
E-Tenders are invited from eligible contractors/firms for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official Website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <https://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these website for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.
A) Fresh-Tender Work:
Sl. No. Jobs No. Name of the work Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
1 02/GM/SM (WC-3)/ 2026-27 M/o Road (Repair & Maintenance of footover Bridge between Sector-50 and Sector-41 on Aghapur road Sector-41), Noida. 19.68
2 09/GM/SM (WC-3)/ 2026-27 M/o Building (M/o Staff Quarter Block Pocket F-64, C-12 in Sector-40), Noida. 29.26
3 11/GM/SM (WC-3)/ 2026-27 D/o Sector (Reconstruction of Boundary wall Sector-48), Noida. 25.44
4 13/GM/SM (WC-3)/ 2026-27 M/o Drain (P/F M.S. Jaal and repair of drain in Village Sadarpur), Noida. 14.55
The above tenders can be uploaded from dated 05.06.2026 to 22.06.2026 up to 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 23.06.2026 at 11.00 AM.
B) Re - Tender Work:
Sl. No. Jobs No. Name of the work Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
5 58/GM/SM (WC-2)/ ET/ 2025-26 Strengthening of Road (P/L DBM & BC, D & C Block Internal road Sector-20), Noida. 28.46
6 17/DGM/SM (WC-5)/ 2025-26 Boundary wall/Barded wire Fencing (P/F Baricading of Bio-Methanation Plant in Sector-71), Noida. 13.80
The above tenders can be uploaded from dated 05.06.2026 to 11.06.2026 up to 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 12.06.2026 at 11.00 AM.
General Manager (Civil) Noida
CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (CIVIL) AU & PC, CSPGCL, Shed No. 2, Dangania, Raipur-492013 Phone No. 0771-2576320 & 0771-2576324, website: www.cspc.co.in E-mail:- cecivil.aupc@gmail.com
No.03-15/W/367671 Raipur, date 03.06.2026
SHORT TERM E-TENDER NOTICE
Online bids are invited through CSPCL e-bidding system (SAP SRM) from eligible bidders fulfilling the eligibility criteria as mentioned below and having experience in Govt./Public Sector Undertaking/Local bodies/Power Generating Companies in India only for the following work :-
Sl. Tender Specification No. Description NIT value i/c GST (Rs.) EMD (Rs.) Completion period (incl. Rainy season) Rfx No.
1 CEC/AU&PC/ABVT PS-MRW/ W/2026/19 Ash utilization by ash filling in low laying area from ash silo of 2x500 MW ABVT/PS, Marwa. 496.14 Lacs 4,96,200/- 04 Months 81000 51918
Cost of tender form is Rs. 1180/- (Rs.1000/- + 18% GST). The due date & time for submission of bids, Tender Cost & EMD is 15.06.2026 (up to 15:00 Hrs) and bid opening date (Techno commercial bids) is 17.06.2026 (up to 16:00) Hrs respectively. The tender document can be viewed and downloaded online from our e-bidding portal <https://ebidding.cspcl.co.in>: 50724/irj/portal.
Note:- (i) The L-1 bidder shall be decided on overall cost to company basis including GST.(ii) In case, the rate quoted by the bidder is on abnormally lower side, a performance guarantee @5% of contract value i/c GST in addition to Security Deposit shall have to be deposited by the bidder.(iii) Maintenance period for the work shall be 12 Months.(iv) Subletting of contract will not be allowed.
Chief Engineer (Civil) AU & PC, CSPGCL, Raipur
//Save Electricity// samvad 48062/1

PUBLIC NOTICE
ICICI Bank
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Ltd., BP-4, Technopolis Building, 4th Floor, Sector V, Salt Lake City, Kolkata West Bengal- 700091. CIN No: L65190G1994PLC021012. www.icicibank.com
The following borrower(s) has/have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest towards the Loan facility(ies) availed from ICICI Bank. The Loan(s) has/have been classified as Non-Performing Asset(s) (NPA). A Notice was issued to them under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, at their last known addresses. However, it has not been served and are therefore being notified by way of this Public Notice.
Sr. No. Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Guarantor/ (Loan Account Number) & Address Description of Secured Asset to be enforced Date of Notice sent/ Outstanding as on Date of Notice NPA Date
1. Rita Singh/ Ginni Lal Singh/ A 303, 3rd Floor Summit Enclave, Bihor Farmecy College, Danapur District Patna Bihar Patna - 801503/ LBPTN00004217763 Commercial Shop/ Unit Bearing No. FB-130 on First Floor. In The Project Named "Galaxy Diamond Plaza" Situated At Plot No. C-1A, Sector-4 Greater Noida, District- Gautam Budh Nagar (U.P) Admeasuring An Area of Super Area of 264 Sq. Ft. (24.53 Sq. Mtrs.) And Built Area of 126,90 Sq. Ft. (11.79 Sq. Mtrs.) 22/04/2026 Rs. 11,20,802.62/- 06/03/ 2026
2. Keisham Anuradha Devi/ Keisham Ibohambi Singh/759, Tower- 9, Hewo Apparts, Part 2 - Gh- 41 Sector 56, Galleria Dlf - IV, Gurgaon Haryana Gurgaon - 122009/ TBGUW00006788688/ LBGUW00006830689 C.S. Dag Nos. 552/665, Patta No. 354 (0) And 946/ 1254 (New), Revenue Village No. 30- Kshetirileikai, Thoubal, District Thoubal, Manipur Admeasuring An Area of 0.02430 Hectares 20/04/2026 Rs. 97,83,257.00/- 14/03/ 2024
These steps are being taken for substituted service of Notice. The above borrower/s and/or guarantor/s (as applicable) is/are advised to make the outstanding payment within 60 days from the date of publishing this Notice. Else, further steps will be taken as per the provisions of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.
Date: June 06, 2026 Sincerely Authorised Officer, For ICICI Bank Ltd., Place: Delhi Ncr

World Briefs
CHINA, MYANMAR FMS HOLD TALKS, DAYS AFTER PRESIDENT TRIP TO INDIA
BEIJING: Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi on Friday held talks with his Myanmar counterpart Tin Maung Swe in Beijing, days after Myanmar President Min Aung Hlaing visited India on his first tour abroad after his election, garnering global headlines. Wang and Tin discussed scaling up bilateral ties and accelerating the development of Myanmar, which for long was caught in civil war between the military junta that ruled the country for decades and ethnic armies. In recent years, China has deepened its influence in Myanmar, backing the military rulers with major strategic investments, which included a route providing it direct access to the Bay of Bengal with oil and gas pipelines.
INDIAN ARRESTED FOR DRUG TRAFFICKING IN NEPAL
KATHMANDU: Two persons, including an Indian, have been arrested from Madhes province of Nepal on charges of drug trafficking, police said Friday. Rakesh Kumar Sah, 21, a resident of Motihari in Bihar, and Ajit Maggiya, 20, a resident of Parsa district from Bishrampur Rural Municipality of Bara district, were arrested in the same district on Thursday for possessing 17.40 grams of brown sugar, a statement by Nepal Police headquarters said. The police recovered the narcotic drugs from the duo while conducting a security check of a motorcycle with Indian number plate. The police have also confiscated the motorcycle, the statement said.

RBI lowers FY27 GDP estimate to 6.6% on West Asia conflict impact

‘Several high-frequency indicators suggest that domestic economic activity has remained largely steady since the outbreak of the conflict’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: The RBI on Friday lowered its GDP forecast for FY2026-27 to 6.6 per cent from the 6.9 per cent estimated in April, citing elevated energy and other commodity prices as well as continued supply disruptions arising from the conflict in West Asia, which are likely to weigh on economic activity.

The central bank also said that prolonged global supply-chain disruptions, heightened volatility in global financial markets, and weather-related shocks continue to pose downside risks to the domestic growth outlook.

Announcing the June bi-monthly monetary policy, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said several high-frequency indicators suggest that domestic economic activity has remained largely steady since the outbreak of the conflict.

India's manufacturing and services PMI suggest that both sectors continue to be resilient, and business expectations are still positive, he said. On the demand side, private consumption



RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said several high-frequency indicators suggest that domestic economic activity has remained largely steady since the outbreak of the conflict

has remained resilient so far. Fixed investment has also maintained its momentum despite rising cost pressures.

Merchandise exports recorded strong growth in April 2026, notwithstanding elevated freight and insurance costs.

Services exports are also holding up well, reflecting sustained demand despite concerns about AI.

Overall, the economic situation has broadly exhibited resilience and withstood the conflict spillovers, although the impact of rising cost pressures is becoming visible, Malhotra said.

“Going ahead, the rise in

Highlights

» Merchandise exports recorded strong growth in April 2026, notwithstanding elevated freight and insurance costs

» Services exports are holding up well, reflecting sustained demand

» ‘Taking all factors into consideration, real GDP growth for FY27 is projected at 6.6%, with Q1 at 6.6%; Q2 at 6.3%; Q3 at 6.5%; and Q4 at 6.8%,’ Guv said

prices of energy and other inputs, coupled with supply disruptions, is likely to weigh on economic activity. While import diversification in affected commodities is likely to improve supply, it would come at a higher cost,” he said.

The Governor further said that the full impact, however,

will depend on the duration of the conflict, time taken for normalisation of supply chains and the burden-sharing approach among the stakeholders.

While weak global demand and high logistics costs are headwinds for merchandise exports, services exports are expected to sustain their momentum as demand for Indian services remains healthy, he added.

“Taking all these factors into consideration, real GDP growth for 2026-27 is projected at 6.6 per cent, with Q1 at 6.6 per cent; Q2 at 6.3 per cent; Q3 at 6.5 per cent; and Q4 at 6.8 per cent,” Malhotra said.

On global economy, the Governor said the outlook remains clouded by the continuing geopolitical impasse in West Asia, as sharply escalating energy prices and global supply chain disruptions continue to hinder economic activity.

Risk-off sentiments and safe-haven demand are imparting volatility to forex markets, with a depreciating trend across many Emerging Market Economy (EME) currencies, he added.

RBI raises FY27 inflation to 5.1% as higher fuel prices hit input costs

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: The RBI on Friday projected the retail inflation for 2026-27 at 5.1 per cent, higher from its earlier estimate of 4.6 per cent, largely due to mounting input costs, triggered by the pass-through of higher global energy prices to retail rates of petrol and diesel.

Since May, retail fuel prices have been raised cumulatively by 7.4 per cent for petrol and 8.4 per cent for diesel.

The increase implies a direct impact of about 36 basis points on headline inflation, which, along with second order effects, would get reflected in consumer price (CPI) inflation in the coming months, the RBI said in its monetary policy statement.

Pass-through of higher global energy prices are also visible in several other inputs such as commercial LPG, industrial raw materials, chemicals, rubber and plastic products, it said, and added the second-round impact of higher input costs could exert upside pressure on CPI inflation going forward.

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said the inflation forecast is subject to upside risks due to global supply chain disruptions, commodity price shocks, uncertainty about distribution of the monsoon and El Nino conditions.

Although firming up marginally from 3.2 per cent in



Since May, retail fuel prices have been raised cumulatively by 7.4% for petrol and 8.4% for diesel

February, headline CPI inflation was below the target during March and April 2026 (3.4 per cent and 3.5 per cent, respectively).

While food inflation edged up, fuel inflation remained muted as retail prices of petrol and diesel were unchanged in March and April. Core inflation remained stable at 3.7 per cent during March-April.

Excluding precious metals, core inflation was much lower at 2.1-2.2 per cent during the same period.

“International crude oil prices (Indian basket) have averaged around USD 110/ barrel during April-May 2026 and indications are that average oil prices for 2026-27 would be substantially higher than what

Key Points

» The increase implies a direct impact of about 36 basis points on headline inflation

» Although firming up marginally from 3.2% in Feb, headline CPI inflation was below target in March (3.4%) & April 2026 (3.5%)

» Excluding precious metals, core inflation was much lower at 2.1-2.2% in same period

were assumed during the last policy statement,” Malhotra said.

Higher energy prices and an increase in several input prices also led to a sharp spike in wholesale price index (WPI) inflation in April 2026, he noted.

The Q1 CPI inflation has been projected at 4.2 per cent; Q2 at 5.1 per cent; Q3 at 5.9 per cent; and Q4 at 5.4 per cent. Core inflation is projected at 4.7 per cent for 2026-27.

RBI also said that adequate stock of foodgrains and satisfactory reservoir levels provide some comfort.

Malhotra also said the food outlook remains uncertain on account of the subnormal south-west monsoon forecast and El Nino.

Reserve Bank announces various measures to boost foreign capital flow, says Governor

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank on Friday announced a slew of measures, including expanding the basket of specified government securities (G-secs) for overseas investors, to attract foreign capital.

“For government securities under the Fully Accessible Route (FAR), we are expanding the universe of specified securities’ by including all new issuances of 15, 30 and 40-year tenor G-secs. In addition, limits pertaining to short-term investment, concentration and individual securities on FPI investment under the General Route are being removed,” RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said.

These measures, along with the tax benefits provided by the government, should help attract foreign capital for government borrowing, he said.

The government has scrapped long-term capital gains tax on investments made by foreign institutional investors



(FIIs) in government securities through an Ordinance issued on Friday.

Commenting on the government move, Malhotra said it is a positive move and it will further strengthen the Balance of Payment.

Besides, the RBI also raised investment limits for non-resident Indians (NRIs) and Overseas Citizens of India (OCIs) in listed equity instruments without requiring registration with the securities regulator.

The facility has now been extended to all individual Persons Resident Outside India (PROIs), broadening access to

Indian equity markets.

The RBI also removed restrictions on short-term investments, concentration limits and individual security limits for Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) investing through the General Route.

Asked about quantum of dollar inflow five measures would lead to, Malhotra said, the RBI is not targeting any specific amount.

However, he said, “We do expect a healthy flow of foreign capital.”

RBI measures, coupled with tax exemptions announced on investments in government securities, are expected to support foreign participation in India's sovereign debt market and facilitate government borrowing at affordable interest rates.

The move also lends support to the rupee, which has weakened more than 6 per cent this year amid rising crude oil prices and foreign portfolio

outflows from equities.

To encourage overseas borrowing, the central bank said it would provide a concessional foreign-exchange swap facility until September 30, 2026, for external commercial borrowings (ECBs) raised by public sector undertakings.

In addition, authorised dealer banks will be eligible for a temporary facility under which the RBI will bear the full hedging cost for fresh three-to-five-year Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank), or FCNR (B) (Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank), deposits mobilised until September 30, 2026.

The RBI also proposed to restore the time for realisation of export proceeds to 9 months.

The measures are aimed at attracting stable foreign capital flows, easing external financing conditions and strengthening India's balance of payments amid heightened global volatility.

Bourses decline marginally after RBI lowered growth projections for FY27

MUMBAI: Benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended lower on Friday amid profit-taking after the RBI lowered its growth expectations for the current fiscal year and forecast inflation to rise to 5.1 per cent.

Also adding to the bearish trend in equities were foreign fund outflows, geopolitical uncertainties and a weak trend in Asian markets.

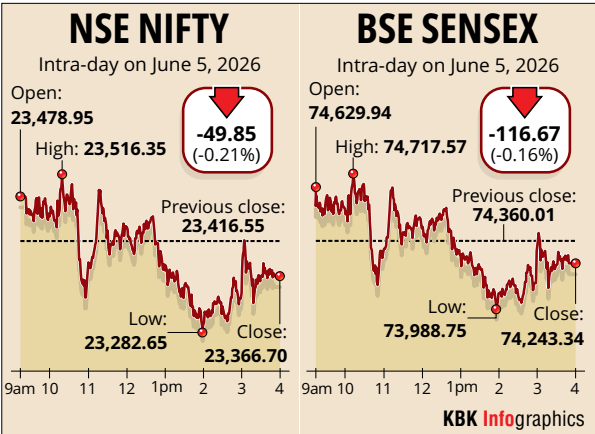
The 30-share BSE Sensex declined 116.67 points, or 0.16 per cent, to settle at 74,243.34.

The 50-share NSE Nifty dipped 49.85 points, or 0.21 per cent, to end at 23,366.70.

On the weekly front, the BSE benchmark declined 532.4 points, or 0.71 per cent, and the Nifty dipped 181.05 points, or 0.76 per cent.

A total of 2,138 stocks declined, while 2,056 advanced and 205 remained unchanged on the BSE.

From the 30-Sensex firms, Trent, TCS, Tata Steel, NTPC, HCL Tech, and Bharti Airtel were among the biggest



laggards.

Hindustan Unilever, Axis Bank, Adani Ports, and Bajaj Finance were among the biggest gainers.

The BSE SmallCap Select index declined 0.24 per cent, while the MidCap Select index went up by 0.29 per cent.

Sectorally, metal dropped 1.62 per cent, Telecom (1.52 per cent), Commodities (0.95 per cent), IT (0.83 per cent), Focused IT (0.77 per cent), and Energy (0.72 per cent).

Hospitals climbed 1.45 per cent, Utilities (0.60 per cent), Realty (0.58 per cent), PSU Bank (0.56 per cent), Healthcare (0.47 per cent) and Consumer Durables (0.45 per cent).

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 4,447.06 crore on Thursday, according to exchange data.

Punnerdeep Singh Brar takes charge as Director (Generation) at PSPCL

PATIALA: Er Punnerdeep Singh Brar on Friday took charge as Director (Generation) of Punjab State Power Corporation Ltd (PSPCL) following his appointment to the post. Earlier, he served as Engineer-in-Chief (P&M) in Ludhiana and was the senior-most serving chief engineer in the corporation. With over 34 years of experience in the power sector, Brar has worked across thermal generation, distribution, enforcement, material services and commercial operations. Brar said his immediate focus would be ensuring uninterrupted operations at Punjab's thermal and hydel power plants during the peak paddy season, when electricity demand rises sharply.



Polymer currency notes plan under consideration, no decision yet: RBI

MUMBAI: RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra on Friday said the central bank is considering a proposal to introduce polymer currency notes, but stressed that no decision has been taken yet and the idea remains at a preliminary stage.

Speaking at the post-monetary policy press conference, Malhotra said the RBI is evaluating the feasibility of polymer notes by examining their potential benefits and drawbacks. “The proposal is under consideration. As soon as any decision is taken, we will inform you,” he said, adding that media reports on the matter contain some truth but no final view has been formed.

The RBI is assessing



whether the introduction of polymer notes would be worthwhile before proceeding further. India had earlier planned a field trial of one billion Rs 10 plastic notes in five geographically diverse cities—Kochi, Mysore, Jaipur, Shimla and Bhubaneswar—in 2014. However, the initiative was later put on hold due to technological and operational challenges.

On concerns regarding cash availability, Malhotra assured that there is adequate currency in the system and that any localised shortages at ATMs would be addressed quickly. He said the RBI has sufficient currency stocks to replenish ATMs and bank branches whenever required.

“Our effort will be to ensure that wherever there is a shortage of currency at ATMs, we will deliver it promptly and at a rapid pace,” he said.

The governor's remarks come amid concerns over cash availability at select locations, with the RBI maintaining that sufficient currency is available for distribution across the banking system.

India's forex stocks jump \$938 million to \$682 billion

MUMBAI: India's forex reserve jumped by \$938 million to \$682.321 billion during the week ended May 28, the RBI said on Friday. In the previous reporting week, the kitty dropped \$7.511 billion to \$681.384 billion.

The kitty had expanded to an all-time high of \$728.494 billion during the week ended February 27 this year before the onset of the Middle East conflict which led to several weeks of a drop as the rupee came under pressure and the RBI had to intervene in the forex market through dollar sales.

For the week ended May 29, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, increased \$3.116 billion to \$546.148 billion, the central bank's data showed.

Expressed in dollar terms, the foreign currency assets include effects of appreciation or depreciation of non-US units, such as the euro, pound, and yen, held in the foreign exchange reserves.

Value of gold reserves declined \$2.186 billion to \$112.6 billion during the week, the RBI said.

The special drawing rights (SDRs) were unchanged at \$18.747 billion, the apex bank said.

India's reserve position with the IMF was up by \$8 million to \$4.826 billion at the end of the reporting week, according to the apex bank's data.

RBI Guv flags risk to rural demand & private consumption from deficient monsoon

Malhotra described the domestic economy as strong and expressed confidence that recent policy measures would help attract higher capital inflows

MUMBAI: Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Governor Sanjay Malhotra on Friday said a projected deficiency in the south-west monsoon could affect rural demand and private consumption, although government and policy measures are expected to soften the impact.

Speaking at the post-monetary policy press conference, Malhotra said rural demand and private consumption have remained resilient so far but may face some moderation if monsoon conditions remain weak.

“Rural demand, yes; private consumption, yes. Some

impact will be there,” he said, responding to a question on the likely effects of a deficient monsoon.

The RBI chief noted that below-normal rainfall could have implications for agricultural output and demand in rural areas.

However, initiatives such as crop diversification, water harvesting and conservation, climate-resilient farming practices and the adoption of short-duration crops are expected to help mitigate the impact.

Malhotra also highlighted risks arising from rising energy and input costs as well as sup-



ply disruptions, warning that these factors could weigh on economic activity if they persist.

While diversification of imports in affected commodities may improve supplies, it is likely to increase costs.

CLOSER LOOK

» RBI chief said that below-normal rainfall could have implications for agri output and demand in rural areas

» He also highlighted risks arising from rising energy, input costs could weigh on economic activity if they persist

» Malhotra stressed that the central bank remains committed to its medium-term inflation target of 4%

“The full impact will depend on the duration of the conflict, the time taken for normalisation of supply chains and the burden-sharing approach among stakeholders,” he said.

Reflecting heightened uncertainty stemming from the West Asia crisis and other downside risks, the RBI lowered its GDP growth forecast for FY27 by 30 basis points to 6.6 per cent from 6.9 per cent projected earlier.

The central bank now expects GDP growth of 6.6

per cent in the first quarter of FY27, 6.3 per cent in the second quarter, 6.5 per cent in the third quarter and 6.8 per cent in the fourth quarter.

Malhotra said prolonged global supply-chain disruptions, volatility in international financial markets and weather-related shocks continue to pose risks to India's growth outlook.

Despite these concerns, he described the domestic economy as strong and expressed confidence that recent policy measures would help attract higher capital inflows.

The RBI on Friday kept interest rates unchanged even

as it raised its inflation forecast for FY27 by 50 basis points to 5.1 per cent.

Malhotra stressed that the central bank remains committed to its medium-term inflation target of 4 per cent.

“Overall, our economic situation is good and we are confident of turning this situation into an opportunity to further strengthen ourselves for the future,” he said.

Deputy Governor Poonam Gupta said the RBI expects a healthy balance of payments position this year, supported by recent policy initiatives. Malhotra added that the cen-

tral bank is not considering any measures to restrict capital outflows.

He said the RBI's primary concern remains the persistence of supply shocks and their impact on prices, followed by inflation risks from a likely deficient monsoon and possible El Niño conditions. The central bank would consider raising interest rates only if inflation becomes persistent and broad-based.

On the proposed introduction of polymer currency notes, Malhotra said the idea is under consideration and remains at a preliminary stage.

‘Target seafood exports worth \$30 billion in next five years’

Goyal also pitched for focusing on quality and manufacturing of value-added products to fetch good prices in international markets

OUR CORRESPONDENT

VISAKHAPATNAM: Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Friday called for increasing seafood exports to \$30 billion over the next five years, from the current \$8.5 billion.

He also pitched for focusing on quality and manufacturing of value-added products to fetch good prices in international markets.

“Let’s target \$30 billion in the next five years,” he said here at the national workshop on seafood exports.

The minister suggested that the target can be achieved by focusing on increasing production and quality.

India has finalised nine free trade agreements with developed nations in the last three and a half years, and it will provide greater market access for the sector, Goyal added.

“Take India’s fish across the world. Reduce import of raw shrimp and export value-added goods and build brands,” he noted.

He said that India’s fisheries exports grew 70 per cent from \$5 billion in 2013-14 to \$8.5 billion last fiscal.



Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal

India’s fisheries exports grew 70% from \$5 billion in 2013-14 to \$8.5 billion last fiscal, Goyal said

The global trade in the fisheries sector grew from \$150 billion to \$164 billion during the same period, the commerce and industry minister added.

When asked about high shipping freight impacting traders, Goyal said that it is a demand and supply situation and regulating these prices will cause more pain and become

Highlights

» ‘Global trade in fisheries sector grew from \$150 billion to \$164 billion during the same period’

» Fisheries Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh said there is a need to raise India’s share in global fisheries exports

» India’s marine product exports reached a record Rs 73,890.46 crore in FY26, with export volumes of 19.72 lakh metric tonnes

» Meanwhile, the sector has set a target of achieving Rs 1 lakh crore in exports

costlier.

There are global trade factors that affect these prices, he added.

On the impact of the West Asia crisis, he told reporters that when the world is witnessing high diesel prices, India has maintained very low hikes in rates.

“Our inflation is amongst the lowest in the world...In

many countries today, diesel and petrol have become a crisis of availability, not one day... in India, we had no line or any shortages or any people suffering,” Goyal said, adding “it is the astute management of our energy needs”.

It is diversified sources of energy that India has generated over the last couple of years and the central government has absorbed a lot of the losses that the oil companies or the fertiliser companies are facing to keep the burden on the common man and businesses low, he said.

The minister said that fertiliser prices today are 10 times the price at which they are made available to the farmers.

“Against Rs 3,000, they are available to the farmers at Rs 300 and the central government is spending over Rs 2 lakh crore as a subsidy to bridge the gap between the international price and the price to the farmers,” he said.

Speaking at the event, Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh said there is a need to raise India’s share in global fisheries exports.

Singh said that efforts are underway to increase value

addition in fisheries exports to maximise gains for exporters and small fishermen.

The minister also called for the creation of infrastructure to promote exports from inland states, whose share is less.

Despite high tariffs (55.8 per cent) by the US, India’s exporters ensured a rise in exports to the European Union, Japan, China and Southeast Asia to offset any losses, he added.

He also hinted that the National Fisheries Board will soon set up a regional office in Andhra Pradesh, the largest producer of fish and seafood exporter in India, with an aquaculture production of 55.39 lakh tonnes in 2025-26, and holds a 66 per cent share in shrimp exports.

India’s marine product exports reached a record Rs 73,890.46 crore (\$8.45 billion) in 2025-26, with export volumes of 19.72 lakh metric tonnes, while the sector has set a target of achieving Rs 1 lakh crore in exports.

The US and China continued to be the principal destinations for Indian seafood exports, while frozen shrimp retained its position as the flagship product.

Govt exempts foreign investors in G-Secs from capital gains tax

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The government on Friday exempted foreign investors from income tax on interest earnings and capital gains from government securities (G-Secs) as it looked to attract foreign capital to counteract pressure on the rupee.

The government promulgated an ordinance to amend the Income Tax Act to provide tax exemptions on interest income and capital gains arising from sale, exchange or transfer of government securities effective from April 1, according to a gazette notification dated June 5.

The exemption would be applicable with effect from April 1, that is the exemption would apply to any interest or capital gains arising to foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) on or after April 1 in respect of investments in G-Secs, the finance ministry said in a statement.

Foreign investors are subject to a long-term capital gains tax of 12.5 per cent on listed shares and bonds held longer than 12 months.

They pay a withholding tax of 20 per cent on interest earned in government bonds.

The Ordinance signed by President Droupadi Murmu defines the BIS as the international financial institution established in 1930 and headquartered in Basel, Switzerland.

It also references existing statutory definitions of FPIs and government securities under



Govt promulgated an ordinance to amend the I-T Act to give tax exemptions on interest income and capital gains arising from sale, exchange/transfer of G-Secs

Indian law.

The gazette notification said the ordinance was necessary as Parliament was not in session and immediate action was required, invoking the President’s ordinance-making powers under Article 123 of the Constitution.

In line with the government’s commitment to strengthen India’s position as a leading global investment destination and to deepen the capital market, the Ministry of Finance has another set of measures aimed at enhancing the ease of investment for individual Persons Resident Outside India (PROIs) and FPIs, and to attract stable long-term foreign capital flows.

With the view to enhance participation by foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) in G-sec, it said, the government has decided to expand the list of specified securities under the Fully Accessible Route (FAR) to also include new issuances in government securities in tenors of 15-year, 30-year and 40-year as also Sovereign Green Bonds in the tenors of FAR-eligible securities.

Further, with respect to FPI investments under General Route, it has been decided to remove the three restrictions, viz. short-term investment limit, concentration limit and the security-wise limit for investments by foreign portfolio investors in G-Secs, while retaining the overall quantitative investment limit of 6 per cent of the outstanding stock of the Central Government securities and 2 per cent of the state government securities (SGSs).

The sub-categories of investment limits, namely, ‘general’ and ‘long-term’ will also be merged into a single limit for investment in Government securities and SGSs, respectively, it said.

These measures will help in development of a smooth yield curve, and attract stable systematic inflow of long-term, patient foreign capital, including long-term investors such as pension funds, insurance companies, and sovereign wealth funds.

This is also expected to boost foreign exchange inflows for the country, it added.

SBI MF buys stakes in 2 Adani cos for ₹5,747 cr from GQG Partners



NEW DELHI: SBI Mutual Fund on Friday bought stakes in Adani Enterprises and Adani Energy Solutions from US-based GQG Partners for Rs 5,747 crore through open market transactions.

SBI Mutual Fund purchased 1,64,39,984 shares representing nearly a 1.3 per cent stake in Adani Enterprises, the flagship entity of the Adani Group, according to block deal data on the NSE. In addition, SBI MF also acquired 63,65,796 shares, amounting to a 0.52 per cent stake in Adani Energy Solutions.

The shares were picked up in the price range of Rs 1,504.80-2,913.40 apiece, taking the combined transaction value to Rs 5,747.55 crore.

Meanwhile, Rajiv Jain-backed GQG Partners, through its affiliate GQG Partners Emerging Markets Equity Fund, offloaded the same number of shares in the two Adani group companies.

The stake buy comes after SBI Mutual Fund last month acquired a 0.45 per cent stake in Adani’s flagship firm Adani Enterprises, for Rs 1,435 crore.

Fully prepared for cyber security threats linked to Mythos, says RBI

‘Operational details are awaited regarding India getting a look into platform built by AI company Anthropic’

MUMBAI: The RBI on Friday said it is fully prepared to deal with cyber security threats linked to the Mythos platform and has already issued required advisories to regulated entities. “We have issued the required advisories. We remain fully prepared in terms of handling cyber security threats of this nature as well as conventional threats,” RBI Deputy Governor Swaminathan J said.

He said operational details are awaited regarding India getting a look into the platform built by frontier AI company Anthropic. “This system has been engaging our attention, both at the government level

‘This system has been engaging our attention, both at the govt level & at the financial sector inter-regulatory forum level’

and at the financial sector inter-regulatory forum level,” he said.

The RBI, in consultation with the government and other regulators, will take further steps once the contours of participation become clear, he said. “We will keep the market

informed once we have full details and know how we plan to handle this,” he added.

Mythos is an AI-based cyber security system developed by Anthropic to detect software vulnerabilities and emerging cyber risks before malicious actors can exploit them.

The company has characterised the technology as highly sensitive due to its advanced capabilities in identifying weaknesses in digital systems.

Although Anthropic disclosed the project in April, it said the model would not be released for public use, citing concerns over the potential misuse if left unrestricted.

NEW DELHI: Hyperscale data centre operator AirTrunk plans to invest more than Rs 3 lakh crore (\$30 billion) in India by 2030 and develop 5 GW of data centre capacity, making the country a key pillar of its global growth strategy. Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the investment plan on Friday after meeting AirTrunk founder and CEO Robin Khuda.

Describing it as one of the largest proposed investments in India’s digital infrastructure ecosystem, Modi said the project would strengthen the country’s position as a global hub for cloud computing and AI.

The Prime Minister said the investment would create jobs, support local supply chains and drive innovation-led growth. “The future of the world’s digital economy is increasingly



Prime Minister Narendra Modi during a meeting with AirTrunk Founder and CEO Robin Khuda, in New Delhi

being shaped in India,” he said in a post on X. AirTrunk, which operates hyperscale data centres across the Asia-Pacific and Middle East region, said India’s scale, talent pool and digital ambitions make it a major long-

term investment destination.

Khuda said Prime Minister Modi’s vision for the digital economy has helped create one of the world’s most attractive markets for technology investment. “India has the scale, tal-

ent and ambition required to become a global AI powerhouse. AirTrunk is excited to support that vision,” he said.

Backed by Blackstone & the Canada Pension Plan Investment Board (CPPIB), AirTrunk said the investment programme would support the next phase of growth in cloud and AI infrastructure. It plans to develop data centre capacity across multiple states and union territories, generating significant economic activity and technology ecosystem growth.

The announcement comes shortly after AirTrunk entered India through the acquisition of Lumina CloudInfra in April. Through the acquisition, the company has secured a development pipeline of 600 MW across Mumbai, Chennai and Hyderabad.

National Jute Board marks World Environment Day 2026, promotes eco-friendly products

KOLKATA: National Jute Board (NJB) observed World Environment Day 2026 at Patсан Bhawan through various awareness and promotional activities supporting environmental sustainability and the use of eco-friendly products.

The programme was attended by more than 250 officials and neighbouring residents including Shashi Bhushan Singh, Secretary, NJB, Neeraj Kulhari Deputy Jute Commissioner, Sanjay Kumar Panigrahi, MD JCI and Dr. Ajeet Kumar, DG of Audit (Mines & Coal).

In an exhibition in this connection was organised with



the participation of eleven jute entrepreneurs showcasing a range of innovative jute products.

Representatives from neighbouring organizations, including Coal India, Power Grid, MSTC, NBCC,

Berger Paints, UCO Bank, and IDBI Bank, visited the exhibition.

The programme also included a plantation drive under the campaign “Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam” and an awareness march with a slogan of “Increase the use of jute and save the environment!” around the Patсан Bhawan premises to promote environmental conservation.

The event concluded with the distribution of around 180 saplings among staff members and visitors in eco-friendly jute bags, replacing plastic wraps and promoting sustainable practices.

MUMBAI: Tata Trusts on Friday dismissed allegations relating to a 1989 share transfer involving the Navajbai Ratan Tata Trust (NRTT), describing them as “baseless, unsubstantiated and mala fide”.

The statement came after reports that Suresh Patilkhede had approached the Charity Commissioner’s office seeking an inquiry into the transfer of 833 shares by NRTT to the late Naval H Tata in 1989.

The move comes ahead of a key Tata Trusts board meeting scheduled for June 8. Tata Trusts said the transaction was lawful, undertaken for consideration and fully compliant with the



regulations in force at the time. It added that the transfer had been vetted at the appropriate levels, including by noted jurist Nani A. Palkhivala & approved by the then board of Tata Sons.

According to the Trusts, the shares were transferred through a valid transfer form duly stamped by the Registrar of Companies.

The organisation alleged that the accusations were aimed at damaging the reputation of Tata Trusts and the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), while also seeking to tarnish the legacy of the Tata family, including Naval H. Tata, the late Ratan N. Tata, Jimmy Tata and Noel Tata.

Describing Patilkhede as a “serial litigator,” Tata Trusts said he has no proven locus standi in the matter and had also initiated legal proceedings against the Trusts in 2020. The Trusts further claimed that in a recent writ petition filed by Patilkhede against SRTT, the Bombay High Court had taken strong exception to his conduct.

OIL’s second Andaman gas find boosts exploration prospects

The discovery was made at the Vijayapuram-3 exploratory well, located around 15 km off the east coast of Andaman

SRI VIJAYA PURAM: Oil India Ltd (OIL) has made its second natural gas discovery in the Andaman offshore basin, bolstering hopes that the frontier region could emerge as a major hydrocarbon-producing area in the future.

The discovery was made at the Vijayapuram-3 exploratory well, located around 15 km off the east coast of the Andaman Islands in a water depth of 355 metres, Union Petroleum and Natural Gas Minister Hardeep Singh Puri said on Friday.

It follows OIL’s first gas discovery at the Vijayapuram-2 well in September 2025. With two successful finds from three



exploratory wells drilled under its Andaman exploration campaign, the company has significantly improved the basin’s exploration outlook.

Puri described the latest find as a positive step towards enhancing India’s energy security through greater offshore

CLOSER LOOK

» Oil Minister Hardeep Singh Puri described latest find as a positive step towards enhancing India’s energy security through greater offshore exploration

» Initial production testing at a depth of over 1,900 metres in the Eocene formation confirmed the presence of natural gas through continuous flaring, he said

exploration. Initial production testing at a depth of over 1,900 metres in the Eocene formation confirmed the presence of natural gas through continuous flaring, he said in a post on X.

The minister noted that the discovery aligns with the Samudra Manthan Mission, the

National Deep Water Exploration Mission announced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in 2025, under which a large number of deepwater and ultra-deepwater wells are planned across India’s offshore basins.

According to OIL, the well

showed encouraging reservoir characteristics. After perforation, it recorded a rapid pressure build-up and commenced production, indicating commercial potential.

Industry experts view the back-to-back discoveries as a significant milestone for exploration in the relatively under-explored Andaman Basin. The company said the find confirms the presence of a working petroleum system and may point to additional hydrocarbon accumulations in the region.

Following the earlier Vijayapuram-2 discovery, OIL launched an extensive appraisal

programme, including reprocessing existing seismic data and acquiring nearly 600 sq km of additional 3D seismic data. The data is currently being processed and interpreted to guide future appraisal drilling.

With two gas discoveries already confirmed, the Andaman offshore region is increasingly being seen as one of India’s most promising frontiers for oil and gas exploration.

“OIL remains committed to advancing exploration through technological excellence and unlocking the nation’s hydrocarbon potential for a secure energy future,” the company said.

RBI Dy Guv Swaminathan J gets two year extension

MUMBAI: The government has extended the tenure of RBI Deputy Governor Swaminathan Janakiraman for another two years. He was appointed as RBI Deputy Governor for three years in June 2023.

“The Central Government has re-appointed Swaminathan Janakiraman as Deputy Governor, Reserve Bank of India, for a period of two years with effect from June 26, 2026, or until further orders, whichever is earlier,” the central bank said in a statement.

According to the RBI Act, 1934, the central bank should have four deputy governors,



two from within the ranks, one commercial banker and an economist to head the monetary policy department.

The other three deputy governors are Poonam Gupta, Shirish Chandra Murmu and Rohit Jain.

Missing pieces in the jigsaw

Ahead of WTC games, India search for missing links against Afghanistan

MULLANPUR: Battling demons of a horrendous home Test run in the not so distant past but nevertheless a formidable unit, India are pitted against a plucky Afghanistan in a one-off Test here that might help the hosts figure out a balanced combination, starting Saturday.

In 2018, Afghanistan lost 10 wickets in a session between lunch and tea on the second day of the Test against India. The next 10 fell by the wayside between tea and end of day's play which also was end of the game.

In 2026, Hashmatullah Shahidi would want his team to at least stretch the home side which is going through a tough transition phase and will be in experimental mode during this game trying different combinations.

However, the Indians would not have forgotten the 0-2 drubbing handed by a meticulously prepared South Africa last year and would do well to not take the opposition lightly despite the gulf in experience.

No. 3 conundrum

A stable No. 3 and Ravindra Jadeja's potential successor in red-ball cricket are the two pieces of the jigsaw puzzle that head coach Gautam Gambhir and skipper Shubman Gill need



to fix during this game before the important two-match Test series against Sri Lanka in August.

Hunt for Jadeja's successor

Ravindra Jadeja has been rested for this match but this is a fact that the Indian selectors

and team management are trying to look at options to prepare themselves for life beyond the Rajkot all-rounder.

The reason for this search is his bowling form, which has deteriorated considerably and he hasn't been as incisive as the

Gambhir keeps faith in Sai

MULLANPUR: India head coach Gautam Gambhir on Friday declared that Sai Sudharsan will get an extended run at the No.3 slot in Test cricket as the young left-hander's six underwhelming appearances in the format aren't enough to make a final judgement on his capabilities.

Sudharsan hasn't really looked at home in the six Tests he has played, aggregating 302 runs at a poor average of 27.45 but the head coach said he would be preferred over his nearest competitor, Devdutt Padikkal, who has been waiting in the wings since the 2024 Test match against Australia in Perth.



"Honestly, Sai hasn't got a fair chance. He's only played what, handful of Test matches. And he started his Test career in England, which we all know is not the easiest place," Gambhir said. "He's had a phenomenal run in IPL (722 runs) as well and we're going to give him a fair chance," added Gambhir.

team management would have liked. What remains Jadeja's USP is his Test match batting in overseas conditions, which is still top notch and hence he has some breathing space.

But Indian cricket has zeroed in on two potential successors. The choice is now between a classical slow left-arm orthodox bowler from Rajasthan named Manav Suthar and the more utility 'bits and pieces' Vidarbha cricketer

Harsh Dubey.

Nothing to lose

The mismatch between the two sides is more evident when one looks at some numbers.

Since Afghanistan's first ever Test against India in 2018 in Bengaluru, which the hosts won inside two days, it has played 11 more games till June 2026. And India, in this same period, have played 67 Tests with Rishabh Pant alone being a part of 49 of them.

UK TOUR FIRST ASSIGNMENT — Shreyas to begin new innings as T20 skipper



Shreyas Iyer will take up the No. 4 slot in the batting

MUMBAI: Shreyas Iyer will formally replace Suryakumar Yadav as India's new T20 captain when the national selection panel meets here on Saturday to finalise squads for the white-ball tour of the UK and the subsequent Asian Games in Japan.

The tour of UK will feature a couple of T20 Internationals against Ireland on June 26 and 28 in Belfast followed by a trip to England for five T20Is and three ODIs beginning July 1.

The Asian Games will take place in September-October in Aichi-Nagoya and the squad is being announced early to meet the deadlines set by the event organisers.

It is expected that young Mumbai Indians batter Tilak Varma will be the new vice-captain, while 15-year-old batting sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi will earn his maiden senior team call-up.

Suyakumar is not only being sacked as India captain despite winning the T20 World Cup earlier this year, he is also being dropped from the squad for his poor form over the last 18 months during which he is suspected to have played with a wrist injury.

The 31-year-old Iyer, who was not a part of the T20 World Cup squad, is expected to take

Chairman of selectors Ajit Agarkar will announce two separate squads for the UK Tour and the Asian Games

on the No.4 slot in the batting line-up.

He is being rewarded for being one of the most astute IPL captains, having taken three different franchises (Delhi Capitals, Kolkata Knight Riders and Punjab Kings) to IPL finals, winning the trophy once. Leading three different set-ups to the title round is no small feat and he is the only IPL captain to do so, an achievement that inspires confidence in his leadership.

Add to it, his batting form has not dipped while captaining and the only blip in his run would be this year's free fall by Punjab Kings during the second half of the IPL after starting out rather well.

Chairman of selectors Ajit Agarkar will announce two separate squads for the UK Tour and the Asian Games set to be held in Japan in September-October.

Pathirage goes past Chopra with big throw at Rome DL

ROME: Neeraj Chopra and Arshad Nadeem need to watch out for Asia's next javelin superstar in the making, Sri Lankan Ramesh Tharanga Pathirage, especially in the Commonwealth and Asian Games later this year.

Pathirage stunned the athletics world with a monster throw of 92.62m to win the prestigious Rome Diamond League title, sending his spear to the second longest distance by an Asian in history and surpassing Indian star Neeraj Chopra. The 23-year-old Pathirage destroyed the 10-man field which includes the likes of two-time world champion Anderson Peters of Grenada, who ended a distant second with 83.91m, Tokyo 2025 World Championships gold medallist Keshorn Walcott of Trinidad and Tobago (83.45m) and bronze medallist Curtis Thompson (83.89m) of the USA. Thompson finished third while Walcott was fourth.

India's 26-year-old Sachin Yadav struggled as he finished a disappointing eighth with a 79.18m effort in his Diamond League debut Thursday night.

Triple threat: Pragg takes down Gukesh, in 3-way battle for title

OSLO: Indian Grandmaster R Praggnanandhaa has put himself firmly in contention for the Norway Chess title after a commanding classical victory over compatriot D Gukesh moved him to within half a point of leader Wesley So of the USA, setting up an intriguing final round battle here.

Praggnanandhaa piled more misery on Gukesh, defeating the world champion in a classical game to earn three full points and put himself in the hunt to become the first Indian chess player to win the prestigious tournament.

He moved into the sole second place on 15 points, just behind American GM Wesley So (15.5) after Round 9, with one round remaining.

The tournament could hardly have asked for a more dramatic finale, with France's Alireza Firouzja also in title contention on 14.5 points in third place, leaving three players with a realistic shot at the title heading into the final round. Significantly, whoever emerges victorious on Friday will be crowned Norway Chess champion for the first time.

Praggnanandhaa will face Germany's Vincent Keymer in the decisive final round, while leader Wesley So takes on Ali-



R Praggnanandhaa is a win away from glory



Bibisara Assaubayeva clinched the women's title

reza in a clash that could determine the destination of the title.

With So on 15.5 points, Praggnanandhaa on 15 and Firouzja on 14.5, all three remain in contention and are likely to push for victory rather than settle for safety.

Meanwhile, reigning world blitz champion Bibisara Assau-

BEATS MENSIK IN SEMIS IN PARIS

Zverev takes a Major step towards elusive Grand Slam title



Alexander Zverev ousted Jakob Mensik in four sets

A dream meets a fairytale

PARIS: Mirra Andrejeva's dream run towards a maiden Grand Slam title at the French Open gathered momentum on Thursday while qualifier Maja Chwalinska continued her own fairytale to set up an unlikely final in Paris.

Early exits for marquee names including defending champion Coco Gauff, four-times winner Iga Swiatek and world number one Aryna Sabalenka opened the door for a new cast of contenders, and both Andrejeva and Chwalinska seized their chances. After

19-year-old Russian Andrejeva secured a 6-1 6-3 win over Ukrainian Marta Kostyuk in a politically-charged semi-final, Chwalinska downed another Russian in Diana Shnaider 7-6(4) 6-4 to continue her remarkable run.

Roland Garros was already guaranteed a new women's champion, and all eyes will be on Court Philippe Chatrier to witness which of the two contrasting journeys culminates in Grand Slam glory and who hoists the Suzanne Lenglen Cup on Saturday.

Rashid cloud hangs over Afghanistan's Test plans

MULLANPUR: Afghanistan head coach Richard Pybus is keen to have a conversation with star leg-spinner Rashid Khan about his long-term red-ball future but admitted that the bowler's chronic back issue and packed global schedule make his immediate Test availability uncertain.

On the eve of Afghanistan's one-off Test against India, Pybus said managing Rashid's workload would be a priority as the team looks to build a sustainable Test programme despite an erratic fixture list.

"Rashid has got this long-standing back complaint. He's got such a huge volume of cricket, you know, he's got to manage himself," Pybus said.

"I look forward to having that conversation to see how we can support him, not only just with the opportunity to maybe continue to play some red-ball cricket if there is potential for that, but generally make sure he can play as long and as healthy as possible for Afghanistan," the Englishman said.

Rashid's absence has once again highlighted the challenges Afghanistan face in balancing the demands of franchise cricket and the Test format, a subject Pybus repeatedly returned to during his first



Rashid has got this long-standing back complaint. He's got such a huge volume of cricket

Richard Pybus, Afghanistan head coach

media interaction since taking charge of the national side.

The former West Indies director of cricket stressed that the larger issue was not merely player availability but the lack of a consistent Test calendar. "When a country gets full membership, it's one thing to get full membership, but then you need to get a full fixture list," Pybus said.

"I'd like to see going forward that the other senior full members also start to build out the list," he added.

Wrestlers Manisha, Neha clinch gold

NEW DELHI: Manisha and Neha clinched gold medals in the women's division to headline a successful day for Indian wrestlers, who secured four gold and two bronze across the Greco-Roman and women's categories at the Ulaanbaatar Open Ranking Series in Mongolia.

The Indian contingent has established a strong position in the overall medal tally with six medals secured so far.

The Greco-Roman unit completed its campaign with two gold medals and one bronze. Sunil won the 87kg gold, defeating Azad Salidinov 4-1, while Nitesh claimed the 97kg title

with a 13-9 victory over Nurassyl Amanaly.

Sumit secured the 60kg bronze medal after defeating compatriot Sahil 5-0.

"The performances by Manisha and Neha, alongside the three-medal showing from our Greco-Roman wrestlers, demonstrate our competitive strength at the international level, winning gold medals against top opponents from DPR Korea and Kazakhstan reflects the quality of our preparation." This successful start provides excellent momentum for the rest of the tournament," said Wrestling Federation of India (WFI) president Sanjay Singh.

Women seek sixth SAFF Championships title in final vs Bangladesh



MARGAO: An unbeaten run in the tournament and goals galore in their kitty, a confident India will start as favourites when they face defending champions Bangladesh in the summit clash of the SAFF Women's Championships here on Saturday.

India would be looking for a record-extending sixth title in the regional tournament with a win against arch rivals Bangladesh whom they have beaten 3-0 in the group stage.

After five title wins on the trot, India could not even reach the finals in the last two editions when Bangladesh walked away with the trophy after beating Nepal on both occasions in 2022 and 2024.

The Crispin Chhetri-coached home side would be eager to make amends of the

losses in the earlier two editions and regain the title they had won last in 2019.

India have so far scored 15 goals -- 14 in the group stage and one against Bhutan in the semifinals -- and conceded none, and they would aim to end the tournament on a blank sheet with Panthoi Chanu under the bar.

The return of star striker Manisha Kalyan in the semifinals has also boosted the team's attacking power. She did not feature in the group game against Bangladesh and would now be eager to show her tricks against the same opponents.

The 24-year-old joined the squad on Tuesday after being released by her Peruvian club Alianza Lima for the June FIFA window that started on June 1 and ends on June 9.

'Mandhana, Verma's form key to India's T2o WC hopes'

MUMBAI: Former captain Diana Edulji believes openers Smriti Mandhana and Shafali Verma finding form quickly will be imperative and crucial to India's chances of winning the Women's T20 World Cup.

India head into the global showpiece, scheduled to be played from June 12 to July 5 after suffering a 1-2 T20I series defeat to the tournament hosts England, with both Mandhana (40 runs) and Verma (35) enduring a lean patch with the bat. "Though it was not a very good series, we have lost 2-1, we need to just focus on our opening partnership," Edulji said on the sidelines of the launch of BBC Research's report on Indian women in sport. "Smriti and Shafali need to get quickly into form, and once they start getting into form, I think that will help India win (at the T20 World Cup)," she added.

Edulji ruled out the notion of a tough draw for India who are placed in Group 1 along with six-times champion Australia and even South Africa, stressing that T20 cricket often produces surprises with its fickle nature. "All the teams that are coming for the World Cup are going to be strong. You may be in any group."

France stunned by Ivory Coast in WC warm-up, Spain held by Iraq

NANTES: Guéla Doué scored a goal and set up the winning strike as Ivory Coast surprised France — and Doué's brother in the French dugout — with a 2-1 victory in a World Cup warmup match.

Amad Diallo fired home Doué's low cross from the right six minutes from time at Stade de la Beaujoire in Nantes Thursday.

Rayan Cherki had put France ahead in the final minute of the first half when he left two defenders behind and beat goalkeeper Yahia Fofana with a low shot.

Fofana was frequently in action, saving the chances of Kylian Mbappé, Michael Olise and again Cherki.

But Doué — whose brother Désiré Doué plays for France — received a through ball from Nicolas Pépé to equalize eight



minutes into the second half.

Many fans waved posters with a photo of Didier Deschamps to thank the coach for a successful reign that began in 2012 and saw France win the

2018 World Cup and reach the 2022 final and will come to an end after this edition.

Deschamps had all six players involved in the Champions League final — Ousmane Dem-

France will play one more warm-up — against Northern Ireland on Monday in Lille

bélé, Bradley Barcola, Warren Zaïre-Emery, Désiré Doué, Lucas Hernandez and William Saliba — on the bench. He used Hernandez, Zaïre-Emery and Barcola as substitutes in the second half.

France will play one more warmup — against Northern Ireland on Monday in Lille — before heading to the United States.

France opens its campaign against Senegal on June 16 in New Jersey.

Ivory Coast meets Ecuador in its opener in Philadelphia on June 14.

Spain held by IraqSpain — another World Cup favorite — was held 1-1 at home by Iraq in La Coruña.

Playing without forwards Lamine Yamal and Nico Williams, Spain took a 1-0 lead in the 16th minute on Ferran Torres' goal.

Merchas Doski's left-footed strike from just outside the box beat goalkeeper Joan Garcia to equalize before the half-hour mark.

Spain coach Luis de la Fuente said he expects Yamal to be fit to face Cape Verde in the team's World Cup opener in Atlanta on June 15.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE
APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Amit S/o Vijay Sharma R/o 16/888, Ganesh Gali, E Block, Bapa Nagar, Karol Bagh, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 172/2022 U/s 380/511 IPC, P.S. Prasad Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Amit** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Amit** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Amit** of case **FIR No. 172/2022 U/s 380/511 IPC, P.S. Prasad Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **11.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Karanbir Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class - 02
Central, Room No. 26
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/7509/CD/2026 (Court Matter)

जिला अभियंता का कार्यालय, जिला परिषद, रामगढ़

एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि इस कार्यालय द्वारा प्रकाशित अति अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या— ZP/RAMGARH/02/2026-27, PR-381239 (District)26-27(D) में तकनीकी कारणों से निम्नवत् संशोधन किया जाता है :-

- वेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि— 10.06.2026
- ई—निविदा डालने / प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय — दिनांक 10, 06.2026 से दिनांक 15.06.2026 अपराह्न 4:00 बजे तक।
- निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय— दिनांक — 16.06.2026 को अपराह्न 4:00 बजे।

हो/-
जिला अभियंता,
जिला परिषद, रामगढ़

PR 381640 District (26-27)_D

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, जामताड़ा

ई—प्रोक्योरमेंट सूचना सं— 01 / 2026—27 1st Call

रू—निविदा प्रसंग— RCD/JAMTARA/420/26-27 दिनांक 30.05.2026

1	कार्य का नाम	IRQP Work of Giridih - Balance work of Widening & Strengthening/Re-construction of Jamtara- Karmatara- Lahariguri Road from Km. 0.00 to Km. 29.175 under Road Division, Jamtara for the Year 2026 -27
2	प्राक्कलित राशि	रु 526.38164 लाख (पाँच करोड़ छब्बीस लाख अदतीस हजार एक सौ चौसठ रुपये) मात्र
3.	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	06 (छह) महीना
4.	ई—निविदा प्राप्त करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	06.07.2026 के दोपहर 12:00 बजे तक
5	ई—निविदा का वेबसाईट पर प्रकाशन की तिथि एवं समय	16.06.2026 के अपराह्न 4:30 बजे से
6.	ई—निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले कार्यालय का नाम एवं पता	कार्यपालक अभियंता, पथ प्रमंडल, जामताड़ा।
7.	ई—प्रोक्यूरमेंट अधिकारी का संपर्क नं० / मोबाईल नं०	9279626462
8.	ई—प्रोक्यूरमेंट सेल का संपर्क सहायता नम्बर	0651-2401010

नोट :- प्राक्कलित राशि घट-बढ़ सकती हैं। निविदा संबंधी अन्य जानकारी <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
पथ निर्माण विभाग,
पथ प्रमंडल, जामताड़ा

PR 381643 Road (26-27)_D

ASSAM UNIVERSITY: SILCHAR
[A Central University]
Advertisement No. 2/2026 dated 26th May, 2026

Online applications are invited from the eligible Indian Citizens and Overseas Citizens of India (OCIs) for various Teaching positions at different department of this university at its HQ: Silchar & Diphu Campus as stated below:

Silchar: HQ: A. Professor: Agricultural Engineering (2UR), Applied Science & Humanities (1OBC), Business Administration (1OBC), Chemistry (1UR), Computer Science (1OBC), Computer Science & Engineering (1UR), Commerce (1UR), Earth Science (1UR), Economics (1UR), Ecology & Environmental Science (1UR), Education (1UR), Law in law subjects (1OBC), Manipuri (1OBC), Philosophy (1UR), Social Work (1EWS), Sanskrit (1EWS), Visual Arts (1EWS). **B. Associate Professor:** Agricultural Engineering (1UR), Arabic (1EWS), Applied Science & Humanities (1SC), Bengali (1UR), Computer Science & Engineering (1UR), Ecology & Environmental Science (1OBC),1UR, Education (1OBC), Electronics & Communication Engineering (1SC), English (1OBC), Economics (1UR) Hindi (1UR), History (1UR), Life Science & Bio-informatics (1UR) Mass Communication (1OBC, 1ST), Manipuri (1OBC), Philosophy (1UR), Political Science(1SC), Sociology (1SC), Visual Arts (1EWS). **C. Assistant Professor:** Agricultural Engineering (1OBC, 1UR), Applied Science & Humanities (1UR), Biotechnology (1SC), Chemistry (1SC, 1OBC), Commerce (1UR), Computer Science (1UR), Computer Science & Engineering (1UR), Centre for Biodiversity and Natural Resource Conservation (1OBC), Earth Science (1SC), Education (1OBC), Education (1ST, Zoology), Education (1UR, Mathematics), Ecology & Environmental Science (1SC, 1UR, 1PWD-LV), Hindi (1UR, 1EWS), Hospitality & Tourism Management (1UR), Law in Law Subjects (2UR), Law-Non-Law subjects (1ST), Manipuri (1UR), Mass Communication (1OBC, 1UR), Mathematics (1OBC), Microbiology (1OBC), Physics (1UR), Pharmaceutical Science (1OBC, 1EWS, 1UR), Political Science (1OBC), Sanskrit (1SC, 1EWS, 1UR).

Diphu Campus: A. Professor: Geography (1OBC), History (1UR), Life Science & Bioinformatics (1EWS), Physics (1UR). **B. Associate Professor:** Commerce (1OBC), English (1EWS), Life Science & Bio-informatics (1UR), Political Science (1SC). **C. Assistant Professor:** Anthropology (1SC, 1EWS), Commerce (1OBC), History (1EWS, 1SC), Physics (1UR), Political Science (1UR).

BACKLOG RESERVED VACANCIES:
Silchar: HQ: A. Professor: English (1ST), Education (1SC), Hindi (1SC), Hospitality and Tourism Management (1ST), Life Science & Bio informatics (1SC), Mathematics (1SC), Mass Communication (1ST), Netaji Subhash Centre (1OBC-PWBD), Political Science (1OBC), Women Study Centre (1OBC). **B. Associate Professor:** Agricultural Engineering (1PWD-OH), Biotechnology (1SC), Business Administration (1ST), Commerce (1OBC), English (1SC), Education (1ST), Electronics & Communication Engineering (1OBC), Earth Science (1SC), History (1SC), Life Science & Bio-informatics (1OBC), Mathematics (1ST), Philosophy (1SC), Physics (1ST).
Diphu Campus: Professor: Political Science (1OBC).

LEAVE VACANCIES:
Silchar HQ: A. Professor: Electronics & Communication Engineering (1UR). **B. Associate Professor:** Economics (1UR). **C. Assistant Professor:** Business Administration (1OBC), Earth Science (1UR, 1OBC), Education (1OBC), Hospitality and Tourism Management (1 OBC), Life Science & Bioinformatics (1UR), Physics (1UR), Social Work (1UR).

The stakeholders may see the general instructions and other details available at www.aus.ac.in and <https://curec.samarth.ac.in/>. All eligibility criteria will be reckoned on the closing date of submission of online application.

Application Fee— **Rs.1000/-** (for General / OBC / EWS category). **SC, ST, PWD** and **Women candidates are exempted from payment of application fees. However they shall required to remit an amount of Rs 500/- as postal expenses only.**

Note:

- This advertisement is in compliance of the Hon'ble Gauhati High Court order dated 28.03.2025 in reference to the Writ Petition No. WP(C)5200/2025.
- If suitable EWS candidates are not found, for the vacancies reserved for EWS, such vacancies will be kept open for UR category, similarly if suitable candidates are not found, for the posts identified for PWBD with specific disability, the said vacancy be kept open for all other type of disabilities. Accordingly UR candidates may apply for the posts reserved for EWS and any PWBD candidate may apply against the posts reserved for PWBD.
- The closing date of submission of online application is 10th July, 2026 at 11.59pm.
- Online mode of submission of application form shall be essential. "Submission of hard copy of application is mandatory." The candidate must submit the hard copy (single copy) along with duly enclosed self-attested copies of all the relevant documents like proof of academic qualifications, experience, caste certificates, OBC-NCL, Disability certificate, Income & Asset and publications etc. having proper serial numbers as claimed by them in the online application.
- Any change / additions / addendum etc. will be notified on in the University website only.

Sd/-
Registrar
cbc 21240/11/0002/2627

OFFICE OF THE COMMISSIONER, MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, GWALIOR (M.P.)
WATER SUPPLY DEPARTMENT

File No. 68/2026x9/1/WS/2026 Gwalior, Date : 02/06/2026

जलपूर्वक 80 प्रमाण 399 **Notice Inviting Tender** दिनांक 04-06-2026

On line tender are invited on behalf of Gwalior Municipal Corporation.

Name Of Work	Probable Amount of Contract	Tender ID No.	Cost of Bid Document & EMD	Last date of purchase online tender dated
वार्ड क्रमांक 52 में सीवर पाइप लाइन विछाने का कार्य।	1,84,56,520.20	2026_UAD 512260_1	12,500/- 92,283/-	19.06.2026

Further details can be seen at <http://mptenders.gov.in>. Executive Engineer, Water Supply Dakshin Vidhansabha Gwalior Municipal Corporation, Gwalior

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE
APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Rizwan S/o Sagir Ahmed R/o D-22, Meer Vihar, Madanpur Dabas, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 210/2017 U/s 324 IPC, P.S. Kanjhawala, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rizwan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rizwan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rizwan** of case **FIR No. 210/2017 U/s 324 IPC, P.S. Kanjhawala, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Apoorv Bhardwaj
Judicial Magistrate First Class
North West, Court No. 113, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/6752/RD/2026 (Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Notice No. : 2026-June-02 dated 05.06.2026

E-Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), N. C. Rly Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:

SN : 1 Tender No : 2026-June-02-01 Approx Cost Rs. : 4500341.07

Description of work : Supply & stacking of 60 Kg/60 EI R260 grade rails AT welding portions under jurisdiction of Sr. DEN-I/Agra.

SN : 2 Tender No : 2026-June-02-02 Approx Cost Rs. : 15931127.40

Description of work : Provision of 05 Nos of Lifts at RKM & FTS stations to recoup divyangjans facility in Agra Division.

SN : 3 Tender No : 2026-June-02-03 Approx Cost Rs. : 58168015.67

Description of work : Creation of Divisional Stores Depot at Agra Division.

• For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website "www.ireps.gov.in". • Tenders can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" up to 15:00 hrs on 26.06.2026. 1274/26 (AS)

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPNCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE
APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Arvind S/o Om Prakash R/o 38/31, Than Singh Nagar, Anand Parvat, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 434/16 U/s 380/411/34 IPC, P.S. North Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Arvind** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Arvind** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Arvind** of case **FIR No. 434/16 U/s 380/411/34 IPC, P.S. North Rohini, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Aakanksha
Judicial Magistrate First Class - 03
Room No. 107
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/7413/RD/2026 (Court Matter)

ALTIOUS CORPORATE REAL ESTATE LLP
PUBLIC NOTICE

LLP NAME: ALTIOUS CORPORATE REAL ESTATE LLP
LLPIN: ACV-4452

Notice is hereby given that pursuant to Section 13 of the Limited Liability Partnership Act, 2008 and Rule 17 of the LLP Rules, 2009, it is proposed to change the Registered Office of M/s ALTIOUS CORPORATE REAL ESTATE LLP from the State of Delhi situated at:

Old Address: House No. Rz 722, Gali No.04, Main Sagarpur, Sagarpur, South West Delhi, New Delhi, Delhi, India, 110046
To the State of Haryana at: New Address: 1st Floor India accelerator, MGF Metropolis, MG Road, Gurugram, Haryana-122002

Any person who has any objection to the proposed shifting of the registered office of the LLP may communicate the same in writing to the Registrar of Companies, Delhi, (Address: 4th Floor, IFCI Tower, G1, Nehru Place, New Delhi – 110019) and to LLP within 21 days from the date of publication of this notice.

For ALTIOUS CORPORATE REAL ESTATE LLP
Sd/-
VIKAS KUMAR
(Designated Partner)

Date: 03.06.2026
Place: Delhi

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No. : JHS-ENGG-N-2026-132 Approx Cost : 62676840.99

Description of work : Part-A:- Jhansi Division : Improvement of staff quarters & other amenities at staff quarters at stations railway colonies in STLI-DHO & BLNR-UDMR section under ADEN/GWL.

Part-B:- Jhansi Division: Improvement of service buildings, roads & protection works for safety of tracks in BLNR-UDMR section under ADEN/GWL.

Earnest Money. : 1253500.00 Date of closing Tender. : 24.06.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 12 Months.

E-Tender No. : JHS-ENGG-N-2026-134 Approx Cost : 199100613.47

Description of work : Jhansi-Sithauli- Rebuilding/Replacement of various Stone Slab bridges by RCC Box / Slab under Jurisdiction of ADEN/LINE (41 No.)

Earnest Money. : 3982000.00 Date of closing Tender. : 24.06.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 18 Months.

• Tender online can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on 24.06.2026 • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in 1255/26 (ADM)

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPNCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE
APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Navneet Kumar, S/o Shivaji Kumar R/o Near Ganda Nala Nihal, Vihar 200M in front of Jawalपुरi Bridge, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.308/2013 Dated 07.12.2013 u/s 279/304A IPC, P.S. Mundka, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Navneet Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Navneet Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Navneet Kumar** of **FIR No.308/2013 Dated 07.12.2013 u/s 279/304 IPC, P.S. Mundka, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.07.2026**.

By Order,
Gaurav Singal
Ld. Judicial Magistrate First Class-06
West Room No.355, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/7495/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE
APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82(2) (ii) Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused persons namely **Tariq Anwar S/o Ziyauddin Ahmad R/o J-4/79, Kalkaji, South East, New Delhi**, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 258/16, U/s 419/420/468/471 IPC.,** has been registered at **PS: Vasant Kunj North, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Tariq Anwar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Tariq Anwar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Tariq Anwar** under **FIR No. 258/16, U/s 419/420/468/471 IPC.,** registered at **PS: Vasant Kunj North, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Animesh Kumar
JMFC-02, Room No. 32
Patiala House Court, New Delhi

DP/7465/SW/2026 (Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE
APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person(s) **Manish Pandey S/o: Daya Shankar Pandey, R/o: H.No. J-200/8, 4th Pusta, Gali No. 2, Kartar Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 72/2014, U/s: 393/394/34 IPC, PS: Kashmere Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Manish Pandey ,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Manish Pandey ,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Manish Pandey, of FIR No. 72/2014, U/s: 393/394/34 IPC, PS: Kashmere Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.07.2026**.

By Order
Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11 (Central) Room No. 138
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/7008/N/2026 (Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

N.I.T. No.	13, 14 & 15 - 2026-27-WV
Name of work with its location : 13. Balance Work of Replacement of dilapidated old washing cum pit line No. 2 & 3 at DEE Depot under Sr.DEN-V. Similar nature of work:- Any Civil work involving concreting work	
14. Upgradation of old Running room post demolishing existing old running room and renovation of lobby building with various facilities to Running Staff at HN2M Station in the section of SSE/W/HNZM under ADEN/HNZM in the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN-V/DLI. Similar nature of work:- Construction of building/Quarters.	
15. Construction of new integrated lobby and running room building with allied offices at Garhi Harsaru in the section of SSE/W/GGN under ADEN/DEE in the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN-V/DLI. Similar nature of work:- Construction of building/Quarters.	
Approx. Cost of work	13, Rs. 18275771.20 15. Rs. 37577623.30
Earnest Money Deposit	(It should be in the form of net banking or payment gateway Only. Note- FDR will not be accepted as EMD for tender invited on IREPS as per Railway Boards letter no. 201025/C-E-I/CT/5/1 dated 31.08.2016)
	13, Rs. 365500.00 14, Rs. 1033400.00 15, Rs. 751600.00
Completion period of Work	13. 06 Months 14. 12 Months 15. 12 Months
Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Upto 15:00 hrs. on 26.06.2026 Opening of tender at 15:00 hrs. On 26.06.2026.
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in
No. 128-W/280/OET/2026-27-W-VNIT-13, 14 & 15-2026-27 Date: 04.06.2026	1916/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE
APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **1. Salman @ Salmi S/o Mosum R/o H. No. A-64, Janta Colony, Welcome, Delhi 2. Vijay S/o Ram Karan R/o H. No. A-62, Gali No. 2, Janta Majdoor Colony, Welcome, Delhi** have Committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 199/2017 U/s 323/452/506/34 IPC, P.S. Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **1. Salman @ Salmi 2. Vijay** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **1. Salman @ Salmi 2. Vijay** have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **1. Salman @ Salmi 2. Vijay** of case **FIR No. 199/2017 U/s 323/452/506/34 IPC, P.S. Welcome, Delhi** are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class - 03
Room No. 19, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/7285/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING
THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Tarsen Singh, S/o.: Anchal Singh, R/o.: K-663, Jahangir Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No. 308/2019 U/S 420/468/471/34 IPC** registered at **PS Jahangir Puri, North West District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said accused **Tarsen Singh** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Tarsen Singh** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Tarsen Singh**, accused of **FIR No. 308/2019 U/S 420/468/471/34 IPC, PS Jahangir Puri, North West District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.07.2026**.

By Order, Ms. Jyoti Nain,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07,
North District, Room No. 6, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/7478/NW/2026 (Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice No. : MECH-ONF-BEMCO-HRE-AMC-26 Date : 03.06.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

For and on the behalf of President of India, Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (O&F)/N.C. Railway, Prayagraj invites the following Single E-Tenders in prescribed forms, from OEM / authorised dealers of BEMCO Hydraulics Limited. The detail of tender is under:-

Tender Notice No. : MECH-ONF-BEMCO-HRE-AMC-26

Name of work : Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract (CAMC) of BEMCO make 03 Set Hydraulic Re-railing Equipment (HRE Set) in Prayagraj division for duration of 03 years under SSE/Loco/PRYJ

Total Estimated Amount of work incl. GST (INR) : 80,88,850.00

Earnest Money (INR) : 0.00 Cost of Tender Form (INR) : 0.00

Duration of Work : 36 months Date of Tender Opening. : 24.06.2026 15:30 Hrs.

Note:- 1. The complete information along with tender booklet of above E-Tenders will be available up to 15:00 Hrs. of 24.06.2026 and shall be remain on website <https://www.ireps.gov.in> the tenderers require submitting their e-tender on this website only. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. 3. Rates entered into any Financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall be considered. Rates and any other financial penalty in any other form / letter head if attached by vendors shall be straightaway ignored and shall not be considered. 4. Document being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. 5. This tender notice has also been uploaded on www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in. 6. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 7. The said supplier of goods and/or services would be subjected to GST ACT and Rules as applicable from time to time. (As per railway board letter no 2016/ACA/1/6 dated 12 may 2017) 1262/26 (AS)

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPNCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING
THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C/84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **GOURAV S/o Subhash Gulati R/o C-1/147, Sultanpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR No. 552/2023, U/s 457/380/411 IPC, PS Aman Vihar, Distt. Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **GOURAV** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **GOURAV** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **GOURAV** of Case **FIR No. 552/2023, U/s 457/380/411 IPC, PS Aman Vihar, Distt. Rohini, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **07.07.2026 at 10:00 AM**.

By Order
Ms. Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class
North-West District, Court No. 109
1st Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/7275/RD/2026 (Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Notice No. : 2026-June-01 Dated: 03.06.2026

E-TENDERING NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), North Central Railway Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:-

S.No.: 1 Tender No.: 2026-June-01-01 Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹ 15000000.00

Description of work: Zone-5: PWL (Excl)- MTJ (Excl) & NCR Qtrs & service buildings at PWL & NDLS- Repair & maintenance work of various items during the year 2026-27 (01.07.26 to 30.06.27).

S.No.: 2 Tender No.: 2026-June-01-02 Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹ 10000000.00

Description of work: Zone-6: MTJ(Excl)-Baad (Incl), MTJ (Excl)-AWR (Excl), MTJ(Excl)- AH(Excl)-BDB Repair & maintenance work of various items during the year 2026-27 (01.07.26 to 30.06.27).

S.No.: 3 Tender No.: 2026-June-01-03 Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹ 15000000.00

Description of work: Zone-10: MTJ only Repair & maintenance work of various items during the year 2026-27 (01.07.26 to 30.06.27).

S.No.: 4 Tender No.: 2026-June-01-04 Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹ 15106033.42

Description of work: (A) Repair to staff quarters in railway colony in KSPV-PWL section under jurisdiction of ADEN-I/MTJ. (B) Roof Replacement & Repair Of BEDM Station Building in MTJ-AWR Section under jurisdiction of ADEN-I/MTJ.

S.No.: 5 Tender No.: 2026-June-01-05 Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹ 697186.50

Description of work: Rag picking along the track in the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN-1/Agra (Balance work).

S.No.: 6 Tender No.: 2026-June-01-06 Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹ 19634049.32

Description of work: Maintenance of 3rd & 4th line in the jurisdiction of SSE/Pway/N/MTJ under ADEN-I/MTJ (Balance work).

S.No.: 7 Tender No.: 2026-June-01-07 Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹ 12000000.00

Description of work: Zone-3 & 4: IDH (Excl)-BXN (Excl) IDH (Excl)-BKI (Excl) Repair & maintenance work of various items during the year 2026-27 (01.07.26 to 30.06.27).

S.No.: 8 Tender No.: 2026-June-01-08 Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹ 13000000.00

Description of work: Zone-7: AGC (Excl)-DHO (Incl), AGC (Excl)-ETW (Excl) and DHO-SRMIT-TPO (NG) (Repair & maintenance work of various items during the year 2026-27 (01.07.26 to 30.06.27).

S.No.: 9 Tender No.: 2026-June-01-09 Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹ 9432597.15

Description of work: Miscellaneous p.way work in SSE/PW/BKI section under ADEN/LINE/AGC.

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website "www.ireps.gov.in". Tenders can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" up to 15.00 hrs on 24.06.2026. 1258/26 (A)

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPNCR



Hrithik says he isn't getting the roles he wants

Roshan answered his fans and implied that he isn't getting as many good roles

Hrithik Roshan is one of the biggest stars that Bollywood has ever seen, but the fans of the actor have often complained that he is quite selective about his films, as they expect him to appear in more films. Very recently, Hrithik Roshan answered his fans and implied that he isn't getting as many good roles.

Hrithik posted a selfie from Paris, with the Eiffel Tower lit up behind him and what he wrote alongside it has got Bollywood talking. "Just got asked what kind of role I'm looking for. And I surprised myself when it came to me. Remember Zaffar from 'Luck By Chance'? That's the one. I'd jump on something like that. But directors only wanna see me play the good guy. Sad."

'Luck By Chance' director Zoya Akhtar took to the comments section and wrote, "Let's get that coffee."

'Luck By Chance' was Zoya Akhtar's directorial debut, released in 2009. The film, produced by Farhan Akhtar and Ritesh Sidhwani, starred Farhan Akhtar and Konkona Sen Sharma as a pair of aspiring actors navigating the internal politics and casual cruelties of the Hindi film industry.

Roshan appeared in an extended cameo as Zaffar Khan, a Bollywood superstar who is charming on the surface and deeply self-serving underneath. Zaffar is



His comment that directors only want to see him play the good guy is not new information to anyone who has followed his career

the kind of star who smiles at everyone, steps on whoever is in his way and frames every act of opportunism as something inevitable rather than chosen.

Hrithik's comment that directors only want to see him play the good guy is not new information to anyone who has followed his career. He has spent the bulk of his filmography playing heroes, literal and figurative. Even his morally complicated roles in movies like 'Bang Bang' and 'War' have been framed within the commercial grammar of the hero who is ultimately on the right side.

The closest he came to genuine grey territory after 'Luck By Chance' was his role in 'Agneepath' in 2012, where he played Vijay Deenanath Chauhan with a cold ruthlessness that sat uneasily alongside the film's conventional revenge structure. However, it didn't change the kinds of scripts that landed on his desk afterwards.

AGENCIES

BATMAN: CAPED CRUSADER S2

Prime Video releases first-look images



The images draw audiences deeper into the underbelly of Gotham City

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Prime Video announced that the highly anticipated returning animated noir series from 'DC Studios', 'Warner Bros. Animation', 'Bad Robot Productions' and '6th & Idaho', 'Batman: Caped Crusader', will premiere all 10 episodes on July 31, along with official first-look images from this thrilling detective show.

The first-look images draw audiences deeper into the underbelly of Gotham City and introduce some of its fan-favourite residents, including Edward Nygma, Carrie Kelly and Roxy Rocket, who will be featured in the upcoming season.

'Batman: Caped Crusader' is a hard-boiled animated series that follows the fearsome vigi-

'Batman: Caped Crusader' is a hard-boiled animated series that follows the fearsome vigilante in his early years

lante in his early years. Forged in the fire of tragedy, billionaire Bruce Wayne becomes something both more and less than human - the Batman. Night after night, against overwhelming odds, he wages his relentless one-man war on crime.

Based on DC characters, the series is a reimagining of the Batman mythology through the visionary lens of executive producers J J Abrams, Matt Reeves and Bruce Timm.

NETFLIX PAUSES PRODUCTION ON 'HANNIBAL' OVER BUDGET CONCERNS

Streaming service 'Netflix' paused pre-production on its untitled historical epic about Carthaginian general Hannibal, starring Denzel Washington, as the studio and producers work to resolve budget concerns.

The film, directed by Antoine Fuqua and written by Oscar-winning screenwriter John Logan, had been slated to shoot in Italy this summer, reported 'Deadline'. Executives on both sides are working to get production back on track and hope the project can still move forward at 'Netflix'.



The untitled historical epic is about Carthaginian general Hannibal

In the movie, Washington would essay the role of Hannibal, who is widely regarded as one of history's greatest military commanders. The story will focus on the battles Hannibal led against Rome during the Second Punic War.

The 'Hannibal' project would mark the sixth collaboration between Washington and Fuqua. They earlier worked together on 'Training Day', 'The Magnificent Seven' and three 'Equalizer' movies.

Washington, 71, has received 10 Oscar nominations and won two Academy Awards in his nearly five-decade career - best supporting actor for 'Glory' in 1990 and best actor for 'Training Day' in 2002.

Fuqua comes to the project on the back of 'Michael', the Michael Jackson biopic he directed, which has grossed over 850 million dollars at the global box office.

PTI

Esha Deol calls Bobby 'finest actor today' after watching 'Bandar'

Bobby Deol has found an admirer in his sister Esha Deol after the release of his film 'Bandar'. The actress attended a special screening of the film in Mumbai and later took to social media to celebrate Bobby's latest performance, calling him 'the finest actor today' and encouraging audiences to watch the film in theatres.

Sharing a photo featuring Bobby and his wife, Tanya Deol, Esha penned a note praising her brother's work in the Anurag Kashyap directorial.

"You are in the best form ever! Undoubtedly the finest actor today. Enduring and vulnerable! Way to go, bhaiya." She concluded her message with a simple recommendation for moviegoers: "Go watch 'Bandar'!" Bobby later re-posted the

Directed by Anurag Kashyap, it is inspired by real-life events and features Bobby Deol in the lead role

post on his 'Instagram Stories'.

Directed by Anurag Kashyap and backed by Nikhil Dwivedi's 'Saffron Magicworks', 'Bandar' is inspired by real-life events and features Bobby Deol in the lead role. The film also stars Sanya Malhotra, Saba Azad, Sapna Pabbi, Indrajith Sukumaran, Raj B Shetty and Jitendra Joshi.

The crime thriller centres on an ageing television star whose life spirals after he is accused of sexual assault by a former girlfriend. 'Bandar' marks the first collaboration between Bobby Deol and Anurag Kashyap. The film had its world premiere in the 'Special Presentations' section at the Toronto International Film Festival in September 2025 before releasing in theatres on June 5.

AGENCIES



'Indian Originals' make a global mark in weekly Top 10 rankings

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Prime Video released its first-ever weekly global rankings of the most-watched 'Original' series and films on the service, offering an official snapshot of the titles resonating most strongly with audiences worldwide. The inaugural rankings further reinforce the growing global appeal of 'Indian Originals', with films and series increasingly breaking into international viewing charts and finding strong traction among audiences in India and across the

world.

The weekly global 'Top 10' rankings (May 25-31) highlight how locally rooted narratives from India are now standing firmly alongside some of the most-watched global 'Originals' on the service.

A major highlight this week is the 'Indian Original' film System emerging as one of the most-watched films globally, securing the No. 2 spot on Prime Video's 'Top 10 Films Worldwide' chart while also claiming the No. 1 spot among 'non-English Prime Original Films'. This



momentum is further supported by continued attention on Indian originals such as 'Matka King' ranking at No. 7 and 'Exam' ranking at

No. 8 in 'non-English Prime Original Series', which have been widely appreciated for their distinctive worlds and strong viewer connection.

This sits within a broader global performance pattern where 'Prime Video India' titles are increasingly appearing alongside international originals in weekly rankings. The list also features globally popular series and films such as 'Off Campus', 'Spider-Noir', 'The Boys', 'Citadel' and 'Jack Ryan: Ghost War', highlighting the shared and highly competitive viewing landscape.



THE PYRAMID SCHEME

A RIDE FULL OF HUMOUR, HUSTLE & UNEXPECTED TURNS

Big dreams, quick-success promises and one small-town world where ambition quickly turns into a rollercoaster of unexpected turns

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Big dreams, quick-success promises and one small-town world where ambition quickly turns into a rollercoaster of unexpected turns. 'The Pyramid Scheme' is a drama set in the world of 'Jumbolife', where Goldy and Manoj's search for success, respect and a better life pulls them into a ride full of humour, hustle, family dynamics and unexpected turns.

Here are five reasons why this rooted, entertaining story deserves a spot on your watchlist:

A story about ambition, choices & the chase for a better life

At its heart, the web series is about people who want more from life, more respect, more security and a chance to change their future. Set against the backdrop of a pyramid marketing busi-

ness, the series follows how ambition, quick success and the desire for a better life can pull ordinary people into unexpected situations. The story keeps the tone entertaining, while staying rooted in family, relationships and everyday aspirations.

A dynamic Goldy & Manoj equation that drives the story

At the centre of the series is the unlikely equation between Goldy and Manoj Srivastava, played by Paramvir Singh Cheema and Ranvir Shorey, respectively. Goldy is ambitious, impatient and eager to rise fast, while Manoj brings a quieter, more restrained energy to the story. Their contrasting personalities create humour, tension and emotional moments, making their journey one of the key highlights of the series.

A strong ensemble that anchors the world

The series brings together a powerhouse cast including Paramvir Singh Cheema, Ranvir Shorey, Shekhar Suman, Aanjan Srivastav, Alfia Jafri and Ashish Raghava in the lead roles, along with Akhilendra Mishra, Smriti Bansal, Vijay Kumar, Indresh Malik, Ravi Behl, Sushant Singh, Sonal Jha and Sadanand Patil in pivotal roles. Each actor adds texture and credibility to the world of 'Jumbolife', making the characters, conversations and relationships feel lived-in and real.

A world built on promises, persuasion & big dreams

'Jumbolife' is a world where pitches, motivation, influence and the promise of transformation drive the story forward. The series uses this setting to explore how quick success dreams can shape people's choices, relationships and sense of purpose. What makes it inter-

esting is that these ideas are woven into a character-led comedy drama, keeping the story entertaining without making it feel preachy.

A signature TVF-style storytelling approach

'The Pyramid Scheme' carries forward TVF's distinct storytelling sensibility, blending humour, emotion, realism and relatable human situations. With its focus on grounded characters, family dynamics, everyday aspirations and the desire to build a better life, the series reflects TVF's strength in turning familiar struggles into memorable, character-led stories.

Produced by 'The Viral Fever', created by Shreyansh Pandey, directed by Ashish R Shukla and Shreyansh Pandey and written by Akshendra Mishra, 'The Pyramid Scheme' is now streaming exclusively on 'Prime Video'.